

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called 'The Chapter of the Thirty-Three'

Ārya-Trayastrimśat-parivarta-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 223 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐུ་ཅ་རྩ་གླུ་སྐུ་པའི་ལེ་འུ་མེས་པ་ཅན་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ་

Toh 223 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Trayastrimśat-parivarta-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra and in Tibetan as the Phags pa sum cu rtsa gsum pa'i le'u zhes bya ba theg pa chen po'i mdo, rendered into English as "The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called 'The Chapter of the Thirty-Three.'" The text takes its name from the Trāyastriṃśa heaven, the realm of the Thirty-Three gods, where the Buddha is depicted as dwelling beside the Pārijāta tree out of loving concern for the mother who gave birth to his form-body. It belongs to the sūtra division of the Kangyur and is set in the Mahāyāna literary tradition, opening with a vast assembly that includes eight thousand arhat monks and seventy-two thousand bodhisattvas. As with many sūtras of this class, it frames its teachings within a richly described celestial setting, connecting the Buddha's compassionate presence in the divine realm to the spiritual instruction that follows.

In the language of India: Ārya-Trayastrimśat-parivarta-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra.

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called "The Chapter of the Thirty-Three."

The first fascicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling among the gods of the Thirty-Three (the Trāyastriṃśa heaven), beside the Pārijāta tree, seated upon a flat stone like an harmonium, out of loving concern for the mother who had given birth to his form-body. The great Saṅgha of monks — eight thousand monks in all — were every one of them arhats: their defilements exhausted, possessed of great miraculous powers, renowned for their great command, and of supreme might. Together with them were seventy-two thousand bodhisattvas, all possessed of the higher knowledges proper to bodhisattvas, having attained patience, their eloquence unobstructed, the great majority gathered from diverse world-realms. All of these had accepted the invitation to spend the rains retreat there together.

Then the Blessed One, surrounded by many hundreds of thousands in his retinue, facing forward, taught the Dharma.

Now at that time two sons of the gods, one named Candra and one named Candraśreṣṭha, had come to be present within that very assembly.

Then the son of the gods Candra rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and with palms joined in the direction of the Blessed One, bowed and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "If I may be permitted to ask — and in asking, may the Blessed One grant me leave, for the sake of a prophecy — I would put certain matters to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to the son of the gods Candra thus: "Candra, for whose benefit do you wish to put your question to the Tathāgata?"

Then the son of the gods Candra addressed the Blessed One in verse:

Those who have entered the path for the sake of medicine for themselves and
medicine for other sentient beings,
who have properly cultivated compassion and loving affection for all sentient
beings,
who seek the dust-free nectar of awakening and strive to accomplish that aim
—

it is for their sake, O Lion of the Śākyas (an epithet of the Buddha, Śākyamuni),
that I, Candra, make this request.

Those who, with undaunted mind, act across countless aeons,
who abandon suffering and liberate all beings without exception,
who bring equanimity of mind and evenness of conduct to all sentient beings
—

it is for those incomparable ones that I make this request to the Victor.

Those who have seen the great field of merit adorned with the body pure of all
stain,
bearing the thirty-two supreme marks and signs of a buddha,
who desire those great ones — vast oceans brimming with qualities —
it is for those of great majesty that I make this request.

Those who at all times, apart from the wisdom of the supreme being,
do not direct their intelligence elsewhere, do not turn their minds elsewhere,

and who do not direct their intelligence toward śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas —
those of supreme skill and steadiness, it is for their sake that I make this request.

Those who regard gain and loss, fame and obscurity, as equal;
who are not disheartened by blame or praise, pleasure or pain;
who overcome the ways of the world and remain unmoved —
those who are free from fear, it is for their sake that I make this request.

Those who regard others as equally dear as they regard themselves,
who make no distinction among the three realms of existence and are even in
their conduct,
who think with loving-kindness and observe proper conduct without the flaw of
pretense —
it is for those persons that I make this request.

Those who always practice generosity and moral discipline with purity of
conduct,
who engage in renunciation of self yet do not abandon the aggregate of ethical
discipline,
who at all times keep body, speech, and mind well restrained —
it is for those who are without stain that I make this request to the Victor.

Those who speak of patience and are endowed with the knowledge of proper
restraint,
who endure suffering, killing, binding, and beating,
who, though provoked by all, do not give rise to anger or resentment —
it is for those resolute ones that I make this request.

Those whose power and diligence abide in strength for the sake of the
supreme purpose,
who wander for the benefit of the world and not for their own sake,
who are never sated with conduct that is pure and bright, like the waters of
the ocean —
it is for those oceans of virtue that I make this request to the Victor.

Those who do not enter deeply into the many kinds of conceptual thought,
who have conquered the many afflictions and possess noble wisdom,
who are endowed with meditative concentration, higher knowledge, the
highest exertion, and the legs of miraculous power —

it is for those who abide in meditative concentration that I make this request.

Those who have gone to the far shore of the perfection of wisdom and possess boundless gnosis,

who are free of thought and conceptuality, free of conceptual elaboration, and have become peaceful,

by whom this Dharma, in its solitude and sublimity, will be understood again and again —

it is for those great individuals that I make this request.

Those who are skilled in miraculous powers and act with the utmost calm and peace,

who travel to worlds by the tens of millions yet have no clinging to any realm,

who bow before buddhas by the tens of millions yet have no clinging to any buddha —

it is for those who are a joy to behold that I make this request to the Victor.

Those who are free of the māra of afflictions and have conquered the māra of the aggregates,

who are free of the māra of the Lord of Death and have conquered the māra of the gods,

who, having definitively conquered all māras, have come to touch awakening —

it is for those who are free of darkness that I make this request.

Those who, having traversed the forests and groves,

awaken to the supreme gnosis of the buddhas, spotless awakening,

and in whom, within a single moment of mind, whatever knowledge there is will arise —

it is for those who are like a vajra that I make this request.

Those who are resplendent with the great brilliance of all-encompassing gnosis,

who always rely upon Dharma practice out of longing for the buddhas,

who conduct themselves as a great delight to guides and to the learned members of the Saṅgha —

it is for those that I make this request throughout the three realms of existence.

Blessed One, who then are the bodhisattvas, the great beings, who have gone to the far shore of supreme great higher knowledge and the excellent

distinction of gnosis? Blessed One, who are the bodhisattvas, the great beings, who possess the knowledge of complete dedication through skillful means that is inconceivable? Blessed One, who are the bodhisattvas, the great beings, who come to attain the knowledge that all phenomena are of one mode, one taste, one entry, and one exposition? Blessed One, who are the bodhisattvas, the great beings, who are possessed of profound moral discipline and act with heedfulness, and who will awaken to unsurpassed, complete, perfect awakening?

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the son of the gods, Candra: "Excellent, excellent, Candra! You have spoken for those who have donned the great armor, for those who wish to liberate the multitude of travelers, for those who wish to light the great lamp of the Dharma, for those who wish to launch the great vessel of the Dharma, for those who wish to turn the great wheel of the Dharma, for those who wish to beat the great kettle-drum of the Dharma, for those who wish to beat the great drum of the Dharma, for those who wish to raise the great victory banner of the Dharma, for those who wish to hold the great pinnant of the Dharma, for those who wish to make the great light of wisdom shine,

for those who wish to follow in the wake of great primordial wisdom, and for those who wish to bring great primordial wisdom to complete perfection — it is excellent that you petition the Tathāgata on behalf of those sentient beings who are endowed with such immeasurable qualities. Therefore, son of the gods, listen well and take it deeply to heart, and I shall explain to you how bodhisattvas, great beings, have gone to the far shore of the supremely distinctive higher knowledge and primordial wisdom; how bodhisattvas, great beings, are possessed of the knowledge of dedication through skillful means that are inconceivable; how bodhisattvas, great beings, come to attain the knowledge that all phenomena are of one manner, one taste, one entry, and one exposition; and how bodhisattvas, great beings, who practice with profound moral discipline and with heedfulness, will fully and perfectly awaken to the unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening.

The Blessed One said: "It is so, Blessed One," and so he requested.

The son of the gods, Candraprabha, listened in the Blessed One's presence, and the Blessed One then spoke these words to him:

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with four qualities, he has gone to the far shore of the supremely distinctive higher knowledge

and primordial wisdom. What are the four? Son of the gods, here a bodhisattva, a great being, is skilled in knowing all phenomena and yet has no attachment to any phenomenon whatsoever. He understands, knows, attains, and makes directly present all phenomena as equal to space, and he engages all phenomena in accordance with the nature of reality, seeing nothing else whatsoever as truly real apart from the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena.

Son of the gods, what does it mean that all phenomena are of one manner? Just as the first extreme, the beginning, is empty, so too the final extreme, the end, is empty, and whatever arises in the present is also empty by virtue of emptiness of essential nature. Son of the gods, that very non-conceptuality with regard to the emptiness of the three times is what is called suchness. And whoever enacts, knows, demonstrates, designates, elucidates, distinguishes, clarifies, and teaches this — such a person is called wise.

Now, how is it that he has no attachment to any phenomenon? Son of the gods, all phenomena are stirred into motion by the stirring of the self. Knowing that all phenomena are thus roused by being set in motion through the placing of mindfulness, he has no attachment to the self. Because he has no attachment to the self, he does not stir other phenomena into motion. Because no phenomenon is known or stirred, he cannot become attached to it. And because he is without attachment, he does indeed establish phenomena, yet he does not become attached to any phenomenon whatsoever.

Son of the gods, how does a bodhisattva, a great being, know all phenomena to be like space? Son of the gods, the three realms are nothing other than mind alone, and that mind itself is without form, cannot be pointed out, is without obstruction, does not make anything clearly cognized, and is like an illusion. Even if one searches through the nature of reality of mind itself, that mind is not found. The mind with which one searches for mind is also not found. Because mind is not apprehended, all phenomena are not apprehended. Because all phenomena are not apprehended, no phenomenon whatsoever is seen as a defining characteristic or as a substance, and one does not become attached to any phenomenon. Because all phenomena are not fully established, he knows them to be like space. Son of the gods, just as space is unborn and not fully established, in just that way does he know all phenomena.

Just as what is called "space" is itself empty of inherent existence, so too all phenomena are nothing more than mere names, and those names as well are empty of inherent existence.

How then does a bodhisattva accord with the nature of reality? Son of the gods, when a bodhisattva, a great being, thoroughly trains in this matter, all these phenomena do not know one another and do not perceive one another. The eye does not know the ear and does not perceive it; the ear does not know the eye and does not perceive it. The nose does not know the tongue and does not perceive it; the tongue does not know the nose and does not perceive it. The body does not know the mind and does not perceive it; the mind does not know the body and does not perceive it. All these phenomena are inert, without activity, without agency.

He thus knows them to be like the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena. Endowed with such wisdom, when any phenomenon appears from among the six sense-objects, he reflects as follows: there is no inner phenomenon here that cognizes something outer, and there is no outer phenomenon here that cognizes something inner.

Knowing thus and seeing thus, he does not genuinely perceive any phenomenon's arising, ceasing, or abiding. Son of the gods, that in which there is no arising, no ceasing, and no abiding is the dharmadhātu.

Son of the gods, furthermore, a bodhisattva reflects: all phenomena abide — they abide in the sense that they are permanently unborn. Because he is endowed with precise individual discernment of all phenomena exactly as they are, he sees no phenomenon that falls outside the nature of reality, and he brings all phenomena into accord with the nature of reality.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is endowed with these four qualities has arrived at the further shore of great direct knowledge and of supreme distinction in primordial wisdom.

Son of the gods, what then is meant by "direct knowledge"? Son of the gods, direct knowledge is the knowing of all phenomena that does not rely on another's instruction. Son of the gods, primordial wisdom is that which does not divide all phenomena into two. Son of the gods, non-duality means: not projecting the eye and visible form as a pair, not projecting the ear and sound as a pair, not projecting the nose and smell as a pair, not projecting the tongue and taste as a pair, not projecting the body and tangible objects as a pair, not projecting the mind and mental phenomena as a pair.

A bodhisattva endowed with such primordial wisdom will attain the five direct cognitions, and these will be attained by perfectly completing aspirational prayers in accordance with one's intentions.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva endowed with such primordial wisdom sees, with the divine eye, incalculable hundreds of thousands of myriads of buddha-fields in the ten directions. He also sees the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who dwell in those buddha-fields together with their assemblies of śrāvakas. With the divine ear he hears in its entirety whatever Dharma those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, teach. In those buddha-fields he fully knows all the intentions and conduct of sentient beings — whether inferior, middling, or superior. And he goes in that very instant to all those buddha-fields. Drawing moreover on his own direct cognition of past lives, he teaches the Dharma.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, endowed with such primordial wisdom thus remains close to sentient beings, performing the activities of a buddha, even before attaining omniscience itself.

And having swiftly completed all the qualities of a buddha, that being will fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, complete, perfect awakening.

Then, at that time, the Blessed One declared these verses:

One skilled and clear in the knowledge of skillful means
perfects the great superknowledges (abhiññā).
Ever knowing all phenomena as like the sky,
such a one is possessed of the profound moral discipline.

The wise one who knows all phenomena just as they are
does not cling to what is known.

Ever knowing all phenomena as like the sky,
ever knowing them as empty and selfless —

one applies oneself in harmony with phenomena and with the dharmadhātu,
seeing nothing apart from the dharmadhātu.

Whoever sees that sees it with heightened vision.

Thus through earnest striving one attains the superknowledges.

Just as phenomena of the past are empty,

so too are phenomena of the future;

and one sees present arising the very same way.

This is how things have always truly been described.

All phenomena are, in all three times, ever empty.
The wise one neither conceptualizes nor engages in conceptual thought.
When one neither conceptualizes nor engages in conceptual thought,
there is no fear in seeing things just as they are.

That one, possessed of insight and clear in wisdom,
teaches the Dharma yet holds no perception of Dharma.
Where there is no conceit, there is nothing to hold on to.
Where there is nothing to hold on to, there is no wavering.

All these phenomena arise from the self,
yet that self is selfless — selfless by its very intrinsic nature.
Even having realized that all phenomena are selfless,
the wise one does not solicit anything else whatsoever.

What is unborn will not arise.
In that there is no clinging.
Teaching all phenomena through settled distinction,
though teaching the Dharma, one has no thought of self.

All three realms of existence come about from mind,
yet that very mind is ever beyond being shown.
Without form, undeclared, like an illusion —
the wise one seeks the nature of reality of mind.

When one seeks the nature of reality of mind,
neither mind nor the nature of reality of mind is seen.
That mind by which mind is sought —
that very mind, too, sees no intrinsic nature.

Such a one is not stained by any phenomena.
No characteristic-mark of desire enters into it.
Knowing that all phenomena are unestablished,
that one ever knows them to be like the sky.

Just as the sky has not been born,
so too one knows all phenomena.
The sky, lacking any essence, is expressed by name.
Phenomena, being empty, are described by names.

The nose does not see what the eye sees.
The eye does not see what the ear sees.
Not by the nose is it the tongue, nor by the tongue the nose —

none of these sees another.

What the body perceives, the mind does not see.

What the mind perceives, the body does not see.

These do not impute anything to one another.

Therefore all of these are ever solitary and apart.

Without activity, without doing, inert —

ever in accord and equipoise with the dharmadhātu.

The inner is not known by the outer,

and the outer is not known by the inner.

Therefore, for one who thoroughly knows these phenomena,

the wisdom of that one is ever boundless.

Though perceiving myriads of buddhas and their śrāvakas in the ten directions,

one does not conceptualize what is seen.

With boundless wisdom and supremely pure moral discipline,

such a one hears all the Dharma those who teach phenomena teach —

hears all that is well proclaimed,

retains it, and holds it perfectly.

That one knows the minds of all sentient beings.

Through miraculous power one goes to myriads of buddha-fields.

One recalls former abodes across inconceivable myriads of aeons,

as numerous as the sands of the Ganges.

Therefore, if one cultivates these five superknowledges,

one will draw ever closer to the wisdom of the Sugata.

That wise one abides always in the activities of a buddha

and, even before attaining awakening, acts for the benefit of beings.

Whoever hears such teaching as this

and in whom great, vast joy arises —

māra will never gain a foothold over that one,

and swiftly will they fully awaken to the supreme enlightenment.

O son of the gods, know that a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is skilled in skillful means beyond all conception. What are the four?

O son of the gods, here a bodhisattva, a great being, is skilled in skillful means in the following way. To whatever degree one sees that one is oneself afflicted

by suffering, mental distress, and disturbance, to that same degree one strives to pacify the suffering of sentient beings. One establishes all sentient beings in the awakening mind, and establishes all phenomena in the awakening mind. One rejoices in the accumulation of merit perfectly accomplished by all sentient beings across the three times, and one rejoices in the accumulation of merit perfectly accomplished by all buddhas across the three times. That very root of virtue one utterly relinquishes and completely gives over to all those sentient beings. There is no intention one generates that is not dedicated to omniscience, and one sees no awakening whatsoever that is apart from the mind. Knowing that the defining mark of awakening is just the defining mark of mind, one inquires accordingly. Having no attachment to either mind or awakening, one who is skilled in skillful means makes the root of virtue grow ever further. One does not see the dharmadhātu as something that could be purified and made perfectly pure; and through realizing phenomena that are beyond conception, one is never content in genuinely accomplishing roots of virtue. One holds no clinging to the activity of mind or to a virtuous mind as supreme. One practices generosity, yet does not conceptualize it. One observes moral discipline, yet holds no attachment to it as supreme. One cultivates patience, yet does not abide in it. One applies diligence, yet knows it to be empty. One enters meditative concentration, yet does not lean upon it. One practices wisdom, yet does not practice it as something absolute. One brings sentient beings to full ripening, yet acts without fixing upon any object. One purifies buddha-fields, yet does so in the manner of being of benefit. One seeks out primordial wisdom, yet does so in the manner of having no seeking. One teaches the Dharma, yet does so in the manner of the inexpressible. O son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who acts in this way renders even the smallest root of virtue immeasurable.

O son of the gods, how does a bodhisattva, a great being, render even the smallest root of virtue immeasurable? O son of the gods, here a bodhisattva, a great being, arouses a perception of immeasurability with respect to all phenomena. For there is no phenomenon of which a limit could be found. Why is that? O son of the gods, all phenomena are empty, signless, and wishless; and what is empty is immeasurable. With a mind made immeasurable, even the smallest gift of Dharma is rendered immeasurable by one skilled in skillful means. Why is that? Because the awakening to which the awakening mind is wholly dedicated is immeasurable. Through that immeasurable conduct, one comes to realize the nature of the immeasurable awakening of the Blessed

Ones, the buddhas.

O son of the gods, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, enters into the conduct of sentient beings —

with skill in skillful means, one remains among sentient beings according to whatever kind of aspiration they hold, staying with them in that very aspiration — through giving, through generous offering, or through teaching the Dharma.

O son of the gods, furthermore, one abides in the nature of generosity, yet not in the nature of moral discipline, not in the nature of patience, not in the nature of diligence, not in the nature of meditative concentration, and not in the nature of wisdom — and yet one both practises generosity and upholds moral discipline, and does not become conceited on that account. Though endowed with moral discipline, one also perfects patience and bears with whatever others have done or left undone. One applies diligence to all wholesome conduct, cultivates meditative concentration, and is skilled in seeing clearly through wisdom.

O son of the gods, furthermore, a bodhisattva who is skilled in knowing skillful means, even when dwelling together with śrāvakas, does not become attached to them, yet sustains life by drawing on whatever is the essence of their teaching. Even when dwelling together with those of the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas' awakening, one does not become attached to them, yet sustains life by drawing on whatever is the essence of that teaching. O son of the gods, a bodhisattva who is endowed with these four qualities is skilled in knowing inconceivable skillful means.

At that point, the Blessed One then declared these verses:

Knowing thoroughly the suffering both of oneself and of others,
one brings one's own suffering to peace
and brings all the suffering of others to peace.

For all sentient beings one arouses the awakening mind,
and to that mind one dedicates all phenomena as a single aim.

Whatever merit belongs to all sentient beings,
gathered across the three times,
and whatever merit belongs to all buddhas —
in all of that one rejoices.

All those virtues one gives to every sentient being,
and with elevated intention one enters upon the wisdom of the buddhas.

Every arising of mind one completely dedicates to awakening,
and apart from the nature of reality one sees neither any other mind nor any
awakening.

One does not see mind and awakening as two distinct things.
Whatever is the defining mark of awakening, that too is the defining mark of
mind.

By the very equality of phenomena, phenomena are equal,
and in that there is no fixed abiding.
The wise one skilled in skillful means
flourishes through wholesome qualities.

In that basic space there is no increase;
the dharmadhātu is inconceivable.
In searching for the phenomena of the buddhas,
one never rests in contentment,
yet the thought "I have flourished through what is wholesome" does not arise
in mind.

In that awakening to which one dedicates,
one does not grasp at it as supreme.

One gives with non-conceptual giving;
one upholds moral discipline free from conceit.
One cultivates patience continuously,
yet has no fixed abiding in regard to sentient beings.

With solitude of mind and body,
one applies diligence continuously.
One perfects unsupported meditative concentration
and reaches the far shore of wisdom.

One ripens sentient beings
yet has no fixed abiding in a referential object.
One thoroughly purifies buddha fields
yet holds no grasping at them as supreme.

One seeks the wisdom of the buddhas
yet has no attachment to letters and syllables.

For one who so conducts oneself,
awakening is not difficult to find.

For one who has aspiration toward the immeasurable, inconceivable,
empty, signless, and wishless —
there too no limit is found.

In order to take hold of beings' aspiration just as it is,
one practises giving yet has no fixed abiding in the way things are.
One both gives and receives,
and practises the Dharma in accordance with whatever is fitting.

Though one has given, one has no attachment to that giving;
the supreme of moral discipline is not something to cling to, nor is patience.

Diligence is not something supreme to cling to, nor is there miserliness toward
wisdom and gnosis.

Though one gives, one practises moral discipline in that very giving;
though one cultivates patience, one is always endowed with diligence.
One does not abide permanently in meditative concentration,
and one who gives is freed through wisdom with certainty.

Though a bodhisattva constantly abides among pratyekabuddhas and
śrāvakas,
one has no desire for the fearlessness those beings possess,
though one always sustains whatever is essential.

Those bodhisattvas who abide in completeness through these Dharmas and
who are without reproach —
their knowledge of skillful means is inconceivable,
and even the smallest act of giving on their part becomes boundless.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva is endowed with four qualities, one thoroughly
understands all phenomena as having a single mode, a single taste, a single
entry, and a single teaching. What are the four? Son of the gods, in this regard
a bodhisattva is skilled in the knowledge of the unmingled dharmadhātu,
follows along with the emptiness of all phenomena, does not superimpose
upon any phenomenon whatsoever — does not superimpose selfhood upon it,
nor does not superimpose otherness upon it — and penetrates all phenomena
through the mode of solitude. Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva is endowed
with those four qualities, one thoroughly understands all phenomena as
having a single mode, a single taste, a single entry, and a single teaching.

Knowing them in this way, one does not enter into duality through worldly and
supramundane phenomena — through those that are blameworthy and those

that are blameless, through those that are defiled and those that are undefiled, through conditioned and unconditioned phenomena. One does not truly see any phenomenon whatsoever as either supreme or inferior. One does not truly see the phenomena of ordinary persons and the phenomena of arhats as separate — for the very intrinsic nature of the phenomena of ordinary persons is the intrinsic nature of the phenomena of arhats. There is neither diminishment nor addition. One knows the single mode — namely, the mode of solitude. One reveals the full differentiation of all phenomena, yet does not truly see the dharmadhātu as severed. One is also endowed with a single patience — namely, the patience of emptiness. One does not divide emptiness and patience into two. One enters into all phenomena through a single entry — namely, entry through non-arising.

Son of the gods, that bodhisattva is close to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, yet does not think, "Have I drawn near, or have I not drawn near?" Why is that? Because from that single mode, one does not truly see sentient beings as one thing and awakening as another. Furthermore, that very non-apprehension of sentient beings is itself awakening.

Then the Blessed One, having thoroughly grasped that very meaning, examined it in an expanded way and at that time declared these verses:

One does not divide the dharmadhātu,
and there is no true apprehension of the dharmadhātu.

Just as the dharmadhātu is, so are all phenomena.

There is no grasping, and there is nothing whatsoever as a substantial thing.

All phenomena follow along with emptiness.

All phenomena — inner and outer, conditioned —
are level and even, without fabrication.

One knows all phenomena to be of a single mode,
and does not superimpose upon any phenomena whatsoever.

One does not rely upon self or other,
having dispelled the notions of self and mine.

In that, there is never any differentiation or division.

One practices solitude and holds solitude in reverence.

One views all phenomena as empty.

Yet when viewing all phenomena in this way,
one does not conceptualize about solitude itself.

One teaches both worldly and world-transcending phenomena,
yet does not greatly enter into dualism.

There is neither blame nor blamelessness.

Regarding phenomena defiled and undefiled, one does not harbor conceit.

Regarding conditioned phenomena and unconditioned phenomena alike,
one makes no division between the two, but always views them as one.

One does not see any phenomenon worthy of benefit
in the ordinary person or in the arhat.

What is taught as the nature of ordinary persons —
those very same things are the phenomena of arhats.

There is nothing to subtract and nothing whatsoever to add.

Through the gateway of solitude, one comprehends the single mode.

Though one knows how to distinguish among all phenomena,
one does not come to make divisions within the dharmadhātu.

Apart from the emptiness of all these phenomena,
patience is one thing, and desire is another thing no more.

One has no conceit regarding emptiness, and no doubt.

These phenomena are without arising and without a nature of coming into
being.

Knowing all things by that single mode of engagement,
for one who practices in this way, awakening is near at hand.

One draws close to incomparable awakening.

Nor is there any bodhisattva in relation to self or to awakening.

One does not apprehend a self in any of these phenomena whatsoever.

And so one realizes awakening through non-apprehension.

Son of a good family, if a bodhisattva, a great bodhisattva, is possessed of four
qualities, one may say that such a one dwells in heedfulness, endowed with
profound moral discipline. What are the four?

Son of a good family, here a bodhisattva, a great bodhisattva, reflects thus:
"What is this thing called moral discipline?" Reflecting correctly and
analytically in this way, one thinks: "What is called moral discipline is good
conduct of body, good conduct of speech, and good conduct of mind."

Then one reflects further: "What is good conduct of body? Not performing the
actions of taking life, taking what is not given, or engaging in sexual
misconduct — that is good conduct of body."

"What is good conduct of speech? Not performing the actions of speaking falsely, of divisive speech, of harsh speech, or of idle chatter — that is good conduct of speech."

"What is good conduct of mind? Not performing the actions of covetousness, ill will, or wrong view — that is good conduct of mind."

Then, reflecting correctly and analytically in this way, one thinks: "Whatever action is performed by body, speech, or mind cannot be designated as blue, or yellow, or red, or white, or crimson, or crystal-colored. Nor is it something to be cognized by eye-consciousness, ear-consciousness, nose-consciousness, tongue-consciousness, body-consciousness, or mind-consciousness. Why is that? Because it is unborn, unarisen, uncreated, and unobstructed. And what is unborn, unarisen, uncreated, and unobstructed is not something to be cognized by any phenomenon whatsoever."

Then one thinks: "What is unconditioned — that is moral discipline, and there is nothing whatsoever to be designated regarding it. And regarding what cannot be designated, I should not cling to it with attachment." Practicing in this way, one does not perceive that moral discipline truly and properly. Whatever dedication of that moral discipline has been made is likewise not truly and properly seen.

In this way, then, a bodhisattva is called one who holds profound moral discipline.

Furthermore, O son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with the understanding that fully knows the view of the transitory collection (the belief in a self based on the aggregates). By means of that understanding, one does not arouse the view of the transitory collection — that view from which the conceptual elaborations of "endowed with moral discipline" or "transgressing moral discipline" would arise.

Furthermore, O son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, has entered into the profound mode of conduct. Acting with vigilance in bodily and verbal conduct, and in the domain of that conduct, one is called endowed with moral discipline. Moreover, one does not conduct oneself by focusing on a self or by focusing on another. Therefore one is called one who holds profound moral discipline.

Furthermore, O son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, is one whose moral discipline is undegraded and unbroken.

O son of the gods, how is it that a bodhisattva, a great being, has moral discipline that is undegraded and unbroken? O son of the gods, focusing on a self amounts to focusing on moral discipline. O son of the gods, one who does not focus on a self does not focus on moral discipline. One who does not focus on moral discipline does not degrade moral discipline, and does not destroy moral discipline. Why does one not degrade it or destroy it? Because one knows all phenomena from their other side — from what they are beyond themselves. And in that which arises from beyond itself, there is no self and no what-belongs-to-self. In that which has no self, there is nothing whatsoever that can be destroyed. Therefore, O son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with these four qualities, one is said to abide with heedfulness, holding profound moral discipline.

Then at that time the Blessed One (the Buddha) spoke these verses:

One whose body is pure, speech is pure, and mind also pure —
that one always conducts oneself in purity.

One who always dwells well restrained —
such a bodhisattva is called one endowed with moral discipline.

These ten wholesome paths of action,
whichever a wise bodhisattva guards,
whatever is done with body, speech, and mind —
the wise declare that to be moral discipline.

That which is uncreated, unarisen, and unborn —
toward it there is no praise and no abiding.
Where there is no praise and no abiding,
no designation whatsoever will be found for it.

That which is always undegraded, unbroken moral discipline —
it cannot be known by the eye,
not known by the ear, not by the nose or tongue,
not discerned by body or mind.

That which is not known by the six sense faculties —
one cannot abide in that.

Yet that itself is seen as perfectly pure moral discipline.
Never is there one who abides focused on moral discipline.

One does not pride oneself on mere moral discipline.
One does not guard the precepts with the perception of a self.

Even while guarding moral discipline, one has no perception of moral discipline.

Such a one, with mindfulness, holds profound moral discipline.

Having fully cleared away the view of the transitory collection,
no arising of views occurs for that one.

One for whom there is no view and no ground for views —
that one does not conceive of moral discipline as discipline or as its transgression.

Having entered the mode of the profound Dharma,
no examination of its ritual is found there.

Perfectly endowed with vigilance, and praised as excellent —
one cannot be despised by others on account of moral discipline.

Focusing on a self leads to focusing on moral discipline.

One in whom there is no self has no moral discipline.

One who conceives of a self or conceives of moral discipline —
that is called an extreme; both are things to be feared.

One who speaks of no-self has no conceit about moral discipline.

One who speaks of no-self has no reliance on moral discipline.

One who speaks of no-self has no pride regarding moral discipline.

One who speaks of no-self has no heroic attitude toward moral discipline.

One whose moral discipline is undegraded, whose moral discipline is unconfused —

that one does not conceive of oneself as "I am endowed with moral discipline."

One in whom there is no perception of self and no perception of moral discipline —

such a one as this is also called profound.

One whose moral discipline is like that — fearless —

In such a one, no degraded moral discipline will ever arise.

That which is free from grasping at any phenomenon —
moral discipline of that kind is praised by the noble ones.

Those childish ones who dwell in a view of self,

who guard moral discipline thinking "I am one who holds precepts" —

when the ease of moral discipline is entirely exhausted,

those ones will not be freed from the three lower destinies.

Those who have dispelled all views of self
are here without self and without what belongs to self.
One who is free from the view of self is endowed with moral discipline.
In such a one there is no fear of future downfall.
Whoever understands moral discipline to be of this character
is unable to look upon degraded moral discipline.
If one sees neither self nor the three aspects likewise,
what need is there to speak of moral discipline or degraded moral discipline?

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the divine youth Candra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how marvellous it is that the unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is so very profound! Blessed One, it is also most wondrous that a bodhisattva, a great being, dwells without fixation in that way, without any grasping, abides in phenomena just as they are, with all conceptual thought completely severed, free from any perception of self, engages in conduct for incalculable aeons, and yet — until all qualities of buddhahood are fully perfected — does not fall into the stage of a śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha, and does not become purified by abandoning the path midway. Blessed One, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with these qualities, then although one is engaged with the profound dharmas, one does not actualize the ultimate limit directly."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the divine youth Candra: "Divine youth, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with four qualities, then although one is engaged with the profound dharmas, one does not directly actualize the ultimate limit. What are the four? Divine youth, a bodhisattva, a great being: first, being firm in one's commitment to attaining the primordial wisdom of omniscience, one dwells at the heart of the matter; second, because one does not abandon any sentient being, one is endowed with undeflated diligence; third, because one has entered upon the path of not severing the lineage of the buddhas, one is endowed with great compassion; and fourth, because one is skilled in dedicating all roots of virtue completely, one is skilled in means. Divine youth, a bodhisattva, a great being who is endowed with these four qualities engages with the profound dharmas and yet does not directly actualize the ultimate limit midway."

Thereupon the Blessed One uttered these verses:

The wise one is always firm in commitment,
and does not abandon the commitment previously made.
The hero does not generate desire for any other vehicle
but strives for the primordial wisdom of omniscience.

Always acting with care and diligence,
one moves ever forward with a mind that does not falter.
Such a one abandons no sentient being whatsoever;
that one's mind is equanimous toward all beings.

With loving care for all these worlds,
one bears suffering with a mind that does not waver.
In order that the lineage of the buddhas not be severed,
one brings forth many precious jewels.

The wise are well trained in skillful means;
without laziness, they dedicate all virtue.
With love and compassion for beings in the river of saṃsāra,
they do not exhaust the defilements midway.

Bodhisattvas who are fearless
and who have gathered well these dharmas —
they engage with the profound dharmas
and never at any time touch the ultimate limit.

Then the divine youth Candra addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, how does a bodhisattva, a great being, engage with the profound?"

When this was asked, the Blessed One spoke these words to the divine youth Candra:

"Divine youth, in this regard a bodhisattva, a great being, does not seek to perfectly accomplish the dharmas of a buddha in order to teach the dharmas of an ordinary person, nor does the bodhisattva remove the dharmas of an ordinary person. The bodhisattva does not see the dharmas of a buddha as something pure and separate, and does not seek to attain the dharmas of a buddha apart from the dharmas of an ordinary person. Nor does the bodhisattva proceed with the thought that the dharmas of an ordinary person are one thing and the dharmas of a buddha are another. The bodhisattva does not proceed with the thought that the dharmas of an ordinary person are narrow and the dharmas of a buddha are vast. Nor does the bodhisattva

proceed with the thought that the dharmas of an ordinary person are defiled and the dharmas of a buddha are undefiled. Furthermore, the bodhisattva thinks: the dharmas that belong to ordinary persons and the dharmas that belong to a buddha cannot be known, seen, or closely examined. Why is that? It is because all of these are empty, and in emptiness there is no knowing, no seeing, and no close examination — for emptiness is inert by nature.

Divine youth, in this way, with regard to the nature of reality of phenomena (dharmatā), the essential nature of phenomena, the abiding nature of phenomena, and the true suchness of phenomena — in all of that there is not the slightest duality by which one might make a distinction, calling something an ordinary person, or a śrāvaka, or a pratyekabuddha, or a perfectly and fully awakened buddha. Divine youth, for bodhisattvas who engage with the profound, there is no such thing as a dharma that is not a buddha-dharma. Why is that? Divine youth, that which in phenomena might be said to be expressible is in fact inexpressible. What is inexpressible is unspeakable. Where there is no speaking, there is no existence. Where there is no existence, there is no arising. Where there is no arising, there is no cognitive apprehension of any thing. Divine youth, all phenomena are also without any thing, and that which is free from the enumeration of all phenomena — that is the dharmas of a buddha. Divine youth, therefore, through this very synonymy, know that the dharmas of a buddha are precisely those that, by way of a mode of conduct that does not conceptualize any phenomenon whatsoever, are free from conceptual thought about all phenomena.

As for those who proceed with conceptual thought, a consciousness that enters into duality arises in them. They engage with the domain of consciousness. Even with regard to those undefiled dharmas of a buddha, those who conceptualize them, and who, having examined them, arouse defilements — such persons do not know the dharmadhātu as either defiled or as purified. Those who know the intrinsic nature of all phenomena hold no dharma to be either a defiling phenomenon or a purifying phenomenon, and therefore there is likewise no conceiving of a defiling phenomenon or a purifying phenomenon — for that has no basis.

Divine youth, it is in such a way that a bodhisattva, a great being, engages with the profound: seeing that there is no dharma whatsoever that is not a buddha-dharma, and seeing with that very seeing as a superior seeing, and seeing in the manner of not-seeing —"

A bodhisattva who sees in this way cannot be overcome by māra or by the gods belonging to māra's host.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the divine youth Candrabhā addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, a bodhisattva, a great being, who has drawn close to such dharmas as these still undertakes birth — and birth, death, and rebirth after death: this is most wondrous."

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, consider this example: an illusionist's conjuration comes and goes, sits and lies down, and even speaks — and yet it conceives of nothing whatsoever. In just the same way, divine youth, one who knows all phenomena to be like an illusion displays every manner of wandering and birth throughout all destinies, and yet conceives of nothing.

Divine youth, a bodhisattva does not conceive of birth and arising with pride, yet takes birth through the power of former blessings."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the divine youth Candrabhā addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, you have declared that a bodhisattva does not conceive of birth and arising with pride — yet the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, was born from the goddess Māyā and dwelled among the gods of the Thirty-Three heavens in the rains retreat out of affection for the mother who had borne his body. How then did the Tathāgata not conceive with pride?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, the Tathāgata was not born from the goddess Māyā."

The divine youth asked: "Then from what was the Tathāgata born?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, the Tathāgata was born from the Perfection of Wisdom. Divine youth, to say that the Perfection of Wisdom is the mother who gives birth to the blessed buddhas is to speak the truth. To say that the Perfection of Wisdom is the mother who gives birth to the blessed buddhas of the past, the future, and the present is to speak the truth. And why is this so? Divine youth, the thirty-two marks of a great being were not born from the goddess Māyā. Divine youth, the thirty-two marks of a great being were accomplished through training in the Perfection of Wisdom. Divine youth, the ten powers of the Tathāgata were not born from the goddess Māyā. The ten powers of the Tathāgata were accomplished through training in the

Perfection of Wisdom. Divine youth, the four fearlessnesses of the Tathāgata were not born from the goddess Māyā. The eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, the great loving-kindness, the great compassion, the great joy, the great equanimity, the unwitnessed crown protrusion, the fruitful going forth, the eye of a buddha, the wisdom of a buddha, the individual perfect cognitions of a buddha, the knowledge of others' minds — divine youth, in brief, all those buddha-qualities of such a kind by which a Tathāgata is counted as a Tathāgata were not born from the goddess Māyā. Divine youth, thus all the immeasurable buddha-qualities of the Tathāgata by which the Tathāgata is counted as a Tathāgata were accomplished through practicing the Perfection of Wisdom and through training in the Perfection of Wisdom."

Divine youth, through this account too you should understand once and for all that the Tathāgata was born from the Perfection of Wisdom and not from the goddess Māyā.

The Second Fascicle.

Then the divine youth Candraprabhā addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, if the Perfection of Wisdom is not produced by any phenomenon, is not created, and does not cause cessation, then how is it, Blessed One, that the Perfection of Wisdom creates a Tathāgata?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, those phenomena by which a Tathāgata is counted as a Tathāgata have no birth, no death and passing, and no arising. Divine youth, it is the Perfection of Wisdom that brings forth a gnosis of that kind — a gnosis that has no birth, no death and passing, and no arising. For from the Perfection of Wisdom there is born a Tathāgata who has no birth, no death and passing, and no arising. Divine youth, that which has no birth, no death and passing, and no arising — such a one does indeed issue forth perfectly from the presence of the Perfection of Wisdom; but from the absence of the Perfection of Wisdom there is no such issuing forth."

Asked: "Blessed One, given that where there is wisdom there is issuing forth, does wisdom then intend or seek that?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, wisdom does not intend or know. Divine youth, if wisdom were something that intended or knew, then from wisdom there would never be any issuing forth at all. Why is that? Because wherever there is intending or feeling, there is no issuing forth whatsoever. Divine youth, because the Perfection of Wisdom does not intend and does not know, wisdom is always an issuing forth."

Asked: "Blessed One, this word 'issuing forth' — whose word is it a synonym of?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, it is a synonym for the absence of conceptual elaboration."

Asked: "Blessed One, if there is no conceptual elaboration, what does it cause to issue forth?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, those who engage in conceptual elaboration do not relinquish birth in the three realms. Those who do not engage in conceptual elaboration do relinquish birth in the three realms. Divine youth, therefore when you ask, 'If one issues forth without conceptual elaboration, what does it cause to issue forth?' — it causes birth in the three realms to issue forth."

Asked: "Blessed One, did the Blessed One teach the Dharma to śrāvakas for the sake of perfectly transcending the three realms?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, I indeed teach the Dharma to śrāvakas taking the desire realm as a starting point, and yet the Tathāgata does not apprehend the desire realm. Divine youth, I indeed teach the Dharma to śrāvakas taking the form realm as a starting point, and yet the Tathāgata does not apprehend the form realm. Divine youth, I indeed teach the Dharma to śrāvakas taking the formless realm as a starting point, and yet the Tathāgata does not apprehend the formless realm. Divine youth, I teach the Dharma for the sake of perfect transcendence, and yet the Tathāgata does not truly see any phenomenon that perfectly transcends. Divine youth, my śrāvakas, by apprehending the desire realm, do not thereby perfectly transcend the desire realm. My śrāvakas, by apprehending the form realm, do not thereby perfectly transcend the form realm. My śrāvakas, by apprehending the formless realm, do not thereby perfectly transcend the formless realm. Divine youth, furthermore, my śrāvakas, by not apprehending the three realms, do not rely upon the three realms —"

— by perceiving all phenomena as emptiness, they make no aspiration toward the desire realm. They make no aspiration toward the form realm. They make no aspiration toward the formless realm. And because they make no aspiration toward the three realms, they are not born in the three realms. For those who are thus unborn, there is no destiny that can be designated.

Divine youth, and yet the noble ones do speak of something called 'perfect transcendence.' Nevertheless, in the ultimate sense, in this there is neither anyone who perfectly transcends nor anyone who comes. Why is that? Divine youth, all phenomena are to be viewed from the standpoint of there being no perfect transcendence. Divine youth, take the example of space: it is unborn, unmade, unarisen, without transition, without coming. All phenomena likewise are to be viewed in the same way.

When this teaching was given, from among the assembly of gods gathered there, seventy-two thousand divine youths gave rise to the dust-free, stainless eye of Dharma with respect to all phenomena. Sixty thousand divine youths who had previously cultivated roots of virtue gave rise to the mind of unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening. Eight thousand bodhisattvas whose roots of virtue had fully ripened gave rise to patient acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena. In the hands of those bodhisattvas, by the power of the Blessed One, vessels of flowers such as had never been seen before suddenly appeared. From those vessels of flowers they scattered them upon the Tathāgata. Those flowers then spread to cover the entire domain of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three on all sides.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, these flower offerings which these divine youths have scattered upon the Tathāgata — such have never been seen before."

Thereupon the divine youth Candrabhadra said to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, even this Tathāgata upon whom flowers are now being scattered has never been seen before. Why is that? Kauśika, the mind by which a sentient being does not see the Tathāgata is a mind that is obstructed and extinguished — it is incapable of seeing. Kauśika, therefore, whatever is seen, all of it has never been seen before. Whatever is heard, all of it has never been heard before."

Śakra said: "Divine youth, have you yourself seen the Tathāgata?"

Candrabhadra replied: "Kauśika, if the Tathāgata were something called 'form,' then I would have seen the Tathāgata. Kauśika, if the Tathāgata were something called 'feeling,' 'perception,' 'formations,' or 'consciousness,' then I would have seen the Tathāgata. But, Kauśika, the Tathāgata is not called 'form,' nor is he called 'feeling,' 'perception,' 'formations,' or 'consciousness.' The Tathāgata is not differentiated by the defining characteristics of the five aggregates, and therefore he is not easy to see.

"Kauśika, furthermore, when you ask me, 'Divine youth, have you seen the Tathāgata?' — I have seen the Tathāgata just as the Tathāgata sees himself."

Śakra said: "Divine youth, how have you seen the Tathāgata?"

Candraprabha replied: "Kauśika, ask the Tathāgata who is present here before you."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how does Candraprabha see you?"

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, he does not see through form. He does not see through feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. He does not see through the past extreme, the future extreme, or what arises in the present.

He does not see through standing, sitting, walking, or coming; through back, side, or front; he sees nothing apart from the nature of phenomena. He does not see through learning, nor through the state beyond learning, nor as possessing the qualities of one beyond learning. He does not see him as an arhat, nor as possessing the qualities of an arhat. He does not see him as being on the ground of a śrāvaka, the ground of a pratyekabuddha, or the ground of a buddha. Kauśika, that is how he sees. Kauśika, whoever sees in this way sees correctly — this is not wrong seeing. Whoever sees correctly sees nothing whatsoever. Whoever sees nothing whatsoever sees with equanimity and does not see with partiality. Kauśika, a Tathāgata who sees in this way is called one who sees all. Kauśika, a Tathāgata who sees in this way is called a Tathāgata — and yet the Tathāgata does not mingle with the dharmadhātu. Kauśika, what do you think? What would a Tathāgata who sees in this way actually see?"

Śakra replied: "Blessed One, the Tathāgata does not see names, nor does he see forms. In this there is not even a single phenomenon that has been counted. Blessed One, does the divine youth Candraprabha also see in the very same way that the Tathāgata sees?"

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, any bodhisattva whatsoever who has attained patience with respect to phenomena that do not arise — all of them, because they do not grasp at any phenomenon through the mode of the dharmadhātu, see no phenomenon whatsoever."

Śakra asked: "Blessed One, has the divine youth Candraprabha attained patience with respect to phenomena that do not arise?"

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, ask the divine youth Candrababha himself, and he himself will answer you."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the divine youth Candrababha: "Divine youth, have you arisen in patience regarding phenomena that do not arise?"

Candrababha replied: "Kauśika, does what does not arise arise?"

Śakra said: "Divine youth, no it does not."

Candrababha said: "Kauśika, if what does not arise were to arise, then in whom would patience regarding phenomena that do not arise arise? Kauśika, the very phrase 'non-arising' is a term borrowed from the dharmadhātu. In the dharmadhātu itself, arising or ceasing is not observed."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought to himself: "Given the teaching of this divine youth — ah, this one has indeed attained patience and is drawing near to unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening."

Then the divine youth Candrababha, knowing with his mind the full range of thoughts in Śakra's mind, said to Śakra: "Kauśika, those who have attained patience are not thereby drawing near to the awakening of a buddha."

Śakra said: "Divine youth, from what do you say this?"

Candrababha said: "Kauśika, the very word 'attained' is a term rooted in the idea of an object of reference, and through reference to an object one does not fully awaken to awakening. The phrase 'patience with respect to non-arising' is likewise a term borrowed from non-arising. And non-arising itself is awakening."

Śakra said: "Divine youth Candrababha, from where should awakening be sought?"

Candrababha said: "Kauśika, awakening should be sought from the essential nature of the self."

Śakra said: "And from where should the essential nature of the self be sought?"

Candrababha said: "It should be sought from that which has not been born, is not born, and will not come to be born. Moreover, no matter how one seeks, the seeking should not stir up either the object sought or the one who seeks."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One, saying:

"Blessed One, it is wondrous that the divine youth Candraprabha possesses such profound wisdom. Blessed One, from where did this divine youth Candraprabha pass away and come to be here?"

Then the divine youth Candraprabha spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods, saying: "Kauśika, when a conjurer's created man or woman — an emanation — passes away, where has it come from, and where does it go after passing away?"

Śakra said: "Divine youth, an illusion or emanation neither dies nor is born. Why so? Because it is free from conceptual thought."

Candraprabha said: "Kauśika, when you ask 'From where did this emanation pass away to come here? And where will it go after passing away from here?' — would not the wise find fault with such a question?"

Śakra said: "Divine youth, that is so."

Candraprabha said: "Kauśika, I understand your question in this way: when you asked 'From where did this divine youth pass away to come here, and after passing away from here, where will he be reborn?' — you were simply asking that question about phenomena that are like illusions. Kauśika, what do you think? Does an emanation conjured by a Tathāgata come, pass away, or take birth?"

Śakra said: "Divine youth, it does not."

Candraprabha said: "Then what? Does such an emanation perform the acts for which it was emanated?"

Śakra said: "Divine youth, it does."

Candraprabha said: "Kauśika, in just the same way, one who has understood all phenomena to be like emanations, like illusions, demonstrates going and coming, passing away and being born, yet harbors no conceptual thought about any of it whatsoever — and still performs every act that is to be done.

"Kauśika, what do you think? When one sees a form in a dream, or hears a sound, or smells a scent, or tastes a flavor, or makes contact with something tangible, or cognizes a mental phenomenon — is anything really there in any of that?"

Śakra said: "Divine youth, nothing is there."

Candraprabha said: "Kauśika, in just the same way, one who has understood all phenomena to have the essential nature of a dream does not become attached, does not become enthralled, and does not become angry toward

things seen, heard, remembered, distinguished, or cognized. Yet that person also teaches those very phenomena — things seen, heard, remembered, distinguished, and cognized — to others, and in that teaching there is no clinging whatsoever."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One, saying: "Blessed One, if in the case of this divine youth Candraprabha neither birth is to be found nor death and passing away is to be found, how will he understand and carry out the full maturation of sentient beings? One in whom there is no birth and no passing away — that is characteristic of a śrāvaka; it is not the ground of a bodhisattva. Blessed One, a bodhisattva should circle in saṃsāra for many thousands of eons."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, whoever is a bodhisattva who has given rise to acceptance regarding phenomena that do not arise — such a one has no conceit about birth and no conceit about passing away. Such a one should be understood to be like an arhat who has passed fully into nirvāṇa a hundred years past. Why so? Because in such a one, neither the perception of self nor the perception of other arises.

"Furthermore, Kauśika, a bodhisattva who abides forever in phenomena of complete nirvāṇa likewise harbors no conceit about birth, no conceit about passing away, and no perception of self."

"Nor does such a one perceive anyone as other. And as for those sentient beings who do not know this acceptance of the nature of phenomena, out of great compassion, deliberately to introduce them to it, such a one wanders through immeasurable hundreds of thousands of ten million aeons without weariness — this is what is supremely difficult to do.

"Kauśika, take this example: suppose a certain person has fallen into a pit of fire and is burning there, and some other being, possessed of great compassion, without regard for body or life, turns away from delight in the five qualities of sensual pleasure in which he had been rejoicing and taking pleasure, reaches into that mass of fire, pulls the person out, and willingly accepts being burned himself. Kauśika, what do you think — is that difficult to do?"

Śakra replied: "Blessed One, it is indeed difficult to do."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, a bodhisattva who is entirely free from all afflictions and yet takes on further existence — that is even more difficult than that.

"Kauśika, therefore, know it also by this further category: a bodhisattva, a great being, will by all means overcome and surpass the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

"Kauśika, you have asked from where this divine youth passed away and came here — hear me explain it. To the east of this buddha-field, beyond seventy-two hundred thousand million buddha-fields, there is a world-system called Spreading Mound of Jewels. In that world-system there are jewel-adorned trees, blossoming with many-colored jewel flowers, and tiered pleasure-garden pavilions equipped with bridges adorned with many kinds of jewels. The great ground there is made of lapis lazuli and is decorated with many hundreds of thousands of jewels. Kauśika, in that world-system called Spreading Mound of Jewels, a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha by the name Supremely Glorious King of the Jewel in Hand teaches the Dharma. In that place, the two vehicles — namely the śrāvaka vehicle and the pratyekabuddha vehicle — are not established at all; that buddha-field is filled exclusively with bodhisattvas, great beings. Kauśika, at each single teaching of the Dharma by the Tathāgata, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Supremely Glorious King of the Jewel in Hand, thirty-six hundred thousand million bodhisattvas attain acceptance. At the very moment of attaining acceptance, those bodhisattvas rise up into the sky to a height of about seven tāla trees, cause all buddha-fields to shake greatly, and then cover all the world-systems of the great trichiliocosm with jeweled lotus blossoms of one hundred thousand petals reaching knee-height, and while remaining thus arrayed they depart through the sky to other buddha-fields in order to behold, pay homage to, and venerate other perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, and to hear the Dharma. Kauśika, not a single bodhisattva who attains acceptance in that buddha-field remains there; at the very moment of attaining acceptance, they depart to other buddha-fields.

"Kauśika, from the arising of that Tathāgata, throughout twelve aeons he teaches the Dharma three times each day and three times each night, once daily —"

at each single teaching of the Dharma, thirty-six billion trillion bodhisattvas attain acceptance, and at the very moment of attaining acceptance they depart to other buddha-fields. Kauśika, for as many bodhisattvas as attain acceptance and depart to other buddha-fields, that same number of bodhisattvas pass away from other buddha-fields and are reborn in that buddha-field. Kauśika, in this way that buddha-field is never left empty of the many hundreds of billions of bodhisattvas.

"Kauśika, from the world-system called Precious Array, the god's son Candra then disappeared from the presence of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, the king called Jewel-Splendor Supremely Exalted, and he came to abide here in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three — in order to behold me, to pay homage, to venerate, to inquire, to put questions, to expound these teachings of the Dharma widely to many beings, and to perfect this acceptance of the Dharma in other bodhisattvas as well.

"Kauśika, this god's son Candra, for the rest of my lifetime, upholding the sacred Dharma, and then after the Tathāgata passes into nirvāṇa, in the final age, the final time, when the sacred Dharma is on the verge of decline — departing from here and passing away, he will be reborn in Jambudvīpa with a human birth equal to that of other human beings, and he will strive to uphold these profound and deeply apparent teachings of the Dharma. Many hundreds of thousands of sentient beings, too, will come to arouse longing for this acceptance of the Dharma. Then in that final age, that final time, when the sacred Dharma declines, he will pass away from the human world and be reborn in the heaven of Tuṣita, and there he will enter into upholding this awakening alongside the bodhisattva great being Maitreya (the future buddha of loving-kindness), who abides in the Tuṣita heaven. He will also cause innumerable hundreds of thousands of gods' sons who have not previously aroused the mind of awakening to arouse it.

"When the bodhisattva great being Maitreya fully and perfectly awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, this god's son will be dwelling here in Jambudvīpa, residing as a householder for ten years, and he will honor and revere the Tathāgata Maitreya together with the Saṅgha of hearers, taking him as his teacher. After that, together with forty-four thousand human beings, he will go forth from home into homelessness, and having gone forth he will uphold the sacred Dharma for the remainder of the Tathāgata Maitreya's lifetime. Even after Maitreya passes into nirvāṇa, for as long as the

sacred Dharma endures he will continue to uphold it. He will please all nine hundred and ninety-six buddhas who will arise in this good aeon, and having pleased them he will pay them honor and will lead the holy life in the presence of each of those Blessed Ones, the buddhas. Thereafter, when as many aeons have passed as there are grains of sand in seventy Ganges rivers, he will fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, and will arise in the world as a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Moonlight."

Then the son of the gods, Moonlight Supreme, spoke to the son of the gods, Moonlight, and said: "Son of the gods, now that the Blessed One has given you a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, has there arisen in you extraordinary joy, clarity, and reverence toward the Tathāgata?"

When he had said this, the son of the gods, Moonlight, spoke to the son of the gods, Moonlight Supreme, and said: "Son of the gods, the Tathāgata does not give prophecies under the sway of desire, nor under the sway of fear. Son of the gods, the Tathāgata gives prophecy solely to bodhisattvas who are training in the training of a bodhisattva. But what is there that could cause extraordinary joy, clarity, or reverence toward the Tathāgata to arise?"

He replied: "Son of the gods, where is clarity to be sought in its fullness?"

He replied: "Clarity is to be sought in its fullness from the mind."

He replied: "Then one who regards the mind as mind — where is clarity to be sought by such a person?"

He replied: "Clarity exists in that which is without grasping."

He replied: "Does supreme clarity exist in that which is without grasping?"

He replied: "Son of the gods, that is indeed clarity — that in which there is neither aversion, nor intense aversion, nor clarity, and in which the clarity of ordinary persons is absent. In having become clear in that way, there is in it no inherent clarity, and from that point on it will never again become averse. Son of the gods, therefore, one who wishes to attain clarity should quickly apply themselves to five qualities — applying themselves in such a way that there is neither joining nor separation. Why? Because in the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, there is neither joining nor separation."

Then the son of the gods, Moonlight Supreme, spoke to the son of the gods, Moonlight, and said: "Son of the gods, when one speaks of the trainings of a bodhisattva, what are the trainings of bodhisattvas?"

He replied: "Son of the gods, that in which there is no body, no bodily restraint, no speech, no verbal restraint, no mind, and no mental restraint — that is the supreme vow of bodhisattvas. That in which there is no mind, no grasping, no accumulation, and no diminution — that, son of the gods, is the training of bodhisattvas."

Then the son of the gods, Moonlight Supreme, spoke to the son of the gods, Moonlight, and said: "Son of the gods, did the Tathāgata give you this prophecy because you had trained in this training?"

He replied: "Son of the gods, it is because I trained in this training that the Tathāgata gave me the prophecy. Why? Because in this training there is no self by whom it might be known, no sense of 'mine,' no grasping at the thought 'I am training.' One who has genuinely entered does not think in that way, with the thought 'I am training.'"

He replied: "How does one genuinely enter?"

He replied: "One who neither adds to, nor diminishes, nor takes up, nor discards that which is equality — and who does not divide phenomena into 'these are superior' and 'these are inferior' with respect to that equality, but discerns each phenomenon as it truly is — one who enters in that way is called one who has genuinely entered."

Then the son of the gods, Moonlight Supreme, spoke to the son of the gods, Moonlight, and said: "Son of the gods, was it because you had attained certain phenomena and abandoned certain phenomena that the Tathāgata gave you the prophecy?"

He replied: "Son of the gods, it was not because I abandoned the phenomena of ordinary persons and attained the phenomena of buddhas that the Tathāgata gave me the prophecy. Son of the gods, it is because I neither abandoned nor attained these phenomena that the Tathāgata gave me the prophecy."

He replied: "In that case, even childish ordinary persons would receive prophecies, for ordinary persons have likewise neither abandoned the phenomena of ordinary persons nor attained the phenomena of buddhas."

He replied: "Son of the gods, what conceptual elaborations do the phenomena of ordinary persons give rise to?"

He replied: "They give rise to conceptual elaborations about emptiness and the nature of reality."

He replied: "And what conceptual elaborations do those phenomena of buddhas give rise to?"

He replied: "They give rise to conceptual elaborations about suchness and the perfect limit."

He replied: "Can emptiness and the nature of reality engage in conceptual elaboration?"

He replied: "Son of the gods, they cannot."

He replied: "Can suchness and the perfect limit engage in conceptual elaboration?"

He replied: "They cannot. Son of the gods, it is from reflecting on just this that I speak as I do: it is because I neither abandoned the phenomena of ordinary persons nor attained the phenomena of buddhas that the Tathāgata gave me the prophecy."

He replied: "Just as emptiness, the dharmadhātu, suchness, and the perfect limit have been prophesied to awakening, has the Tathāgata likewise prophesied you to awakening?"

He replied: "I have been prophesied in exactly the same way as emptiness, the dharmadhātu, suchness, and the perfect limit. Son of the gods, the suchness of all these phenomena is as it is, and the prophecy given is likewise. The one who gives the prophecy is likewise. And whoever fully and perfectly awakens, or has fully and perfectly awakened, is likewise."

Then the son of the gods, Moonlight Supreme, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, this son of the gods, Moonlight, is endowed with profound wisdom."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of the gods, this is the nature of reality of bodhisattvas who have attained the tolerance of the unborn. Whatever questions and answers they put forth are all put forth from the dharmadhātu alone, and yet the dharmadhātu itself cannot be taught, answered, or expressed. Why is that? Because the dharmadhātu is inexpressible and unspeakable. Just as the dharmadhātu is, so too is the realm of sentient beings. Just as the realm of sentient beings is, so too is the domain of buddhas. And all phenomena are likewise."

"Son of the gods, bodhisattvas who thus follow in accord with the dharmadhātu are called those who do not depend on others."

While this discourse was being spoken, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana was sitting in the great mansion named Victorious in Beauty, teaching the Dharma to a great assembly. Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana rose from his seat and began to walk about. He thought to himself: "Alas, this Jambudvīpa has become empty of Tathāgatas — fully accomplished buddhas, worthy ones. There are many sentient beings with virtuous intentions, and yet, not hearing the Dharma, they will utterly deteriorate."

Then, for this very reason, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana surveyed this Jambudvīpa with his divine eye. He saw that the Tathāgata, the worthy one, the fully accomplished buddha, was receiving food in the great city of Rājagṛha, in the palace of King Bimbisāra, together with a great Saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks. He thought: "Might there be here some monk comparable to me?" And he saw a monk comparable to himself sitting to the left of the Blessed One, eating his meal. He then examined his own body.

Having examined that monk, he saw not the slightest difference between them. The monk's height was exactly the same as his own — neither more nor less. His complexion, his marks, and his form he found to be without distinction. And so he thought: "Has the Tathāgata come to Jambudvīpa?" He then looked toward the Nyagrodhārāma and there too he saw the Tathāgata, surrounded by a host of gods, teaching the Dharma and dwelling there, with Śāriputra seated to his right, a monk comparable to Mahāmaudgalyāyana seated to his left, and other great śrāvakas assembled there as well.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana was filled with profound wonder and thought: "The blessed buddhas are wondrous! The blessed buddhas possess great miraculous power, great renown, and great might — for in this way, in Jambudvīpa the stream of Dharma teaching flows unbroken, and in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three too the Dharma is taught to the gods of the Thirty-Three."

Then, being filled with yet greater wonder, he gazed out once more over Jambudvīpa, and he saw the Tathāgata in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the realm of the prince Jeta, dwelling there with his face turned forward, teaching the Dharma and surrounded by many hundreds of thousands of retinues. There too he saw a monk identical to himself — the same complexion, the same marks, the same form. He saw Śāriputra, the great Kāśyapa, the great Kātyāyana, Gavāṃpati, Subhūti, Aniruddha, Revata,

Kapphiṇa, and all the other great śrāvakas — each of them appearing exactly the same in stature. Just as it had been in Rājagṛha, so too it was in the Jeta Grove. And just as it had been in the Jeta Grove, so too it was in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, filled with yet greater wonder, looked out over Jambudvīpa and saw the Blessed One dwelling in the great city of the Śākyas, in the Nyagrodhārāma, and also going on alms rounds in the great city of the Śākyas. There too he saw a monk comparable to Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and other great śrāvakas as well. Likewise, he saw the Tathāgata in the great city of Vaiśālī, in the home of the young Licchavi Vimalacandra, partaking of a meal and dwelling there. There too he saw a monk of exactly that same complexion, that same set of marks, that same form, and other great śrāvakas as well.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana saw the Tathāgata having gone on alms rounds into the great city of Vārāṇasī and returning therefrom. There too he saw a monk of exactly that complexion, those marks, and that form — identical to himself — and other great śrāvakas as well.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana surveyed this Jambudvīpa and saw the Tathāgata in every place where he dwelt — whether in a temple, in a walking-meditation ground, at the foot of a tree, on a flat stone, or in any suitable location — and in every single one of those places he saw the Tathāgata surrounded by the Saṅgha of monks, his face turned forward, dwelling in various modes of activity.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, filled with great wonder, surveyed the northern continent of Uttarakuru, and there too he saw the Tathāgata together with the great Saṅgha of monks — going on alms round in the northern continent of Uttarakuru, then, having received alms, seated and partaking of the meal. There too he saw a monk of exactly his own complexion, marks, and form, and also other great śrāvakas besides.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana surveyed the eastern continent of Pūrvavideha, and there too he saw the Tathāgata dwelling in the midst of a great assembly of people, teaching the Dharma. There too he saw a monk of exactly his own complexion, marks, and form, and also other great śrāvakas besides.

Likewise, in the western continent of Aparagodānīya, he saw the Tathāgata dwelling in meditative absorption, with many thousands of living beings seated

around him making prostrations, and all the great śrāvakas entering into meditative absorption in the samādhi of the fire element. There too he saw a monk identical to himself.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, filled with great wonder, surveyed the abode of the gods of the earth, and there too he saw the Tathāgata together with the Saṅgha of monks, teaching the Dharma. There too he saw a monk of exactly his own complexion, marks, and form, and also other great śrāvakas besides.

Likewise, when he surveyed the abode of the gods of the middle sky, he saw the Tathāgata there as well, teaching the Dharma to many hundreds of retinues. There too he saw a monk identical to himself, and other great śrāvakas besides.

In the same way it was among the gods of the retinue of the Four Great Kings, among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, among the gods of Yāma, among those of Tuṣita, among those of Nirmāṇarati, and among those of Paranirmitavaśavartin — in every case it was just the same.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana surveyed all the way up to the Brahma world, and in the Brahma world too he saw the Tathāgata surrounded by many hundreds of thousands of Brahmā gods, his face turned forward, teaching the Dharma. There too he saw a monk of exactly his own complexion, marks, and form, and exactly the same stature.

All those monks resembling Maudgalyāyana were teaching the Dharma through miraculous displays of supernatural power, and all of them were known by the name Maudgalyāyana. All those monks resembling Śāriputra were roaring the lion's roar before their assemblies with the great radiance of wisdom, and all of them were renowned by the name Śāriputra. In this way each of those great śrāvakas taught the Dharma by bringing forth his own particular power.

Then the great Maudgalyāyana, joyful and elated, his hair standing on end in wonder, with joy and supreme joy arising in him, uttered three times this solemn utterance:

Wondrous are the buddhas, the Blessed Ones!

Most wondrous are the buddhas, the Blessed Ones!

Then the great Maudgalyāyana, pronouncing the words "Homage to the buddhas! Homage to the buddhas!" rose from his splendid pavilion and with

great force made prostration with his five limbs.

At that moment a tremendous sound rang out through the world, and all the realms of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three were shaken. Many hundreds of thousands of the gods' sons were disturbed by this, and they addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, by what cause and what condition has this great noise arisen —"

— and this great earthquake has arisen in the world?" When they had spoken these words, the Blessed One addressed those gods' sons with the following words: "Gods' sons, because this monk Maudgalyāyana holds the buddhas most dear, he made prostration to the great earth — and this earthquake is the power of that."

They asked: "Blessed One, why did the great monk Maudgalyāyana make prostration to the great earth?" The Blessed One declared: "Gods' sons, Maudgalyāyana is coming — ask him directly."

Then the elder, the great Maudgalyāyana, rose from his splendid pavilion and went to where the Blessed One was, with the greatest swiftness and over the greatest distance. Arriving, he touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down before the Blessed One with his ten fingers joined in reverence, and praised the Blessed One in verses:

O Protector, peerless, supreme among men, beyond compare,
who has cast off the last trace of the three defilements, with tamed mind,
supreme among persons, become the worthy object of offerings for gods and humans —
the Victor's conduct of mind is inconceivable and beyond measure.

When many hundreds of thousands of suns rise together,
all blind sentient beings still cannot see.
Likewise, he who possesses the ten powers and is radiant with light on every side —
even so, for all the hearers, he is not easy to know.

All these hearers are like the blind:
they do not grasp what is called the vehicle of the buddhas.
They approach the Tathāgata with faith and devotion,
yet they do not perceive the true nature of reality of the Victors.

Like a crow beside the great ocean, like a single mustard seed beside Mount Meru, the king of mountains, like the light of the sun beside a firefly — such is the assembly of hearers before the presence of a buddha.

The mountains (Meru) do not desire to be compared to mustard seeds; the sun in the sky does not desire to be compared to a firefly; the great ocean does not desire to be compared to a crow's puddle — so too the bodhisattvas do not desire to be compared to the hearers.

Like the sighted compared to the blind among humans and gods, like a wheel-turning king compared to an ordinary person, like the moon's light outshining the stars — such is the assembly of hearers before the presence of a buddha.

When the Victor resides here at the summit of this Meru, invited by the goddess of illusion (Māyā) out of compassionate purpose, and the buddha, the monks, and the Saṅgha are not present with me in Jambudvīpa, I feel in my mind that this Jambudvīpa is empty.

Blessed One, I am present within the splendid pavilion,
teaching the Dharma to the divine daughters.

With my divine eye I looked down toward Jambudvīpa
and examined hundreds of cities and market towns.

As I looked, I saw the Victor there,
in Rājagṛha, in the hall of the great sage Kapilavatthu —
with the people of the district and his retinue looking on from the front,
he was receiving alms together with the hearers.

On his left side I saw Maudgalyāyana, who resembles me in complexion;
on his right I saw Śāriputra and others,
and I beheld all the hearers of the Victor assembled around him.

I thought: "The Victor has gone up to Meru" —
but when I looked, I saw him dwelling on the summit of Meru.

And I saw that I myself was both present in Rājagṛha
and also present on that very summit of Mount Meru.

In the city of Śrāvastī I also saw the Protector of the World
teaching the Dharma to many millions of living beings,
and there too I saw myself and Śāriputra
and whatever other hearers were present.

I saw him entering Śākya village to collect alms —

And I saw him returning again from Vaiśālī.
In Vārāṇasī likewise I saw him in the same way.
Everywhere too I saw my own body,
and likewise in the northern continent of Uttarakuru
I saw him wandering for alms together with his assembly.
Within the lake Anavatapta, together with the hearers,
I saw him accepting the alms-food offered to him.
Likewise in the western continent of Godānīya
I saw him acting for the benefit of many millions of sentient beings.
Everywhere I saw Maudgalyāyana subduing
beings by the power of his miraculous abilities.
Likewise in the eastern continent of Pūrvavideha
I saw him teaching the various aspects of Dharma to the people there,
and there too I saw myself and Śāriputra
and whatever other hearers were present.
In the same way, in the divine abodes of the heavens above the earth
and in the intermediate sky, I saw him dwelling and teaching the Dharma.
You, the holy sovereign of Dharma, the protector of the world —
I saw you dwelling there and teaching the Dharma to the four assemblies.
Likewise I saw him among the gods free from conflict,
and then I saw the Lion of the Śākyas in the Tuṣita heaven,
and in the heaven of Nirmāṇarati and in Paranirmitavaśavartin as well —
I saw the Protector there together with his hearers.
In the Brahma worlds I saw him dwelling among ten million Brahmās
teaching the aspects of Dharma.
Everywhere I also saw my own body,
and likewise I saw all the hearers of the Victor.
In temples and in forest dwelling places,
in the caves where buddhas had resided in former times —
everywhere I saw the sovereign of Dharma resembling the Lion of the Śākyas,
the king of Dharma just as he is.
O hero, having seen this nature of reality as it is yours,
I was filled with astonishment and wonder.
The supreme miracles of those buddhas who are luminous —
all of this is wondrously great.
Though he remained among the thirty-three gods as their guide,
he appeared and dwelt everywhere throughout Jambudvīpa,
in villages and in the districts and cities,

teaching the Dharma in a form harmonious with each.
O Protector of the World, just as I have seen you,
so too I saw Śāriputra and Mahākauṣṭhila,
Kappina and Nandaka, the son of Kātyāyanī,
Gavāṃpati and Subhūti and Kāśyapa.
Ānanda, with virtue like an ocean of learning,
I saw petitioning the buddhas everywhere.
Everywhere I saw my own body, equal in color and marks,
with nothing superior or inferior — so I beheld it.
"Homage to the buddhas beyond all conceptual measure" —
thus did I proclaim these words intentionally at the peak of Meru,
my hair standing on end, and I remained there in reverence,
paying homage also with my five limbs prostrate upon the ground.
Mighty sounds resounded and spread in all directions.
The grounds of the triple thousandfold world system trembled greatly.
This very summit of Meru was illuminated everywhere.
Having seen the power of those Victors who bring joy,
I have now come from very far away,
and here where the supreme among men resides I am present,
petitioning you, O learned one, for a discernment of Dharma.
Tell me the suchness of the Victors, the Tathāgatas —
how they manifest their transformations
in Jambudvīpa and in the divine worlds,
in the southern, eastern, and northern directions,
in the Brahma worlds and in the intermediate sky —
tell me the suchness of the Victors in all of this.
Having seen this great miracle of the great Teacher,
I have this day truly made a fine attainment.

Now, after seeing these buddhas and their vehicles, I grieve today that I have fallen so low. If my mind is not yet fully liberated, let me at least now arouse the mind set on awakening. O Blessed One, I have nothing to offer, for my defilements are exhausted. I am not a vessel fit for this buddha-wisdom. Just as one who goes to sea in search of jewels — alas! — throws away the precious gem and takes up a mere shell instead, so too know that those sentient beings who abandon awakening and become śrāvakas are just like that. Those sentient beings who are inferior and hold wrong views will never

give rise to the mind set on vast awakening. But those who are endowed with diligence and rest in true power — they arouse aspiration for the wisdom of the buddhas. O Protector, I press my palms together and bow to those who have entered into the supreme buddha-wisdom. Just as the Lion of the Śākyas manifests his transformations, I have not the slightest doubt or misgiving about this.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: Mahāmaudgalyāyana, you have merely seen and observed your own domain as it appears to you. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the buddha-domain of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is inconceivable — not even all beings who have become pratyekabuddhas could fully know or cognize it. How then could you, who practise in a single direction and possess knowledge of a single direction, know it by seeing? Mahāmaudgalyāyana, furthermore, teach the Dharma discourse called "The Miraculous Display of Transformations Through Supernatural Power" of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, and by that time gather together those of the assembly who have not yet arrived, and have those of the assembly who are already gathered be seated. Blessed One, as you request, said the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and having complied with the Blessed One's instruction, with his body blazing and radiating beams of light, he took his seat in the Brahma world at that moment and proclaimed in a voice that resounded through the world-systems of the four great continents, and at that time spoke these verses:

In countless tens of millions of eons,
the arising of Tathāgatas is exceedingly rare —
like the udumbara flower, so it is said;
beholding the Guides is equally rare.

You who are a wheel-turning king of great supernatural power,
endowed with the power of merit and with a thousand sons,
possessing the seven precious things and all that is desired —
come, listen to the Dharma of the Buddha.

You who wish to become Śakra (Indra) or Brahmā,
or who here desire the joys of gods and humans,
those others always wishing to dwell happily in pleasure —
come as to the king of Dharma and go to him.

The passing beyond sorrow that is nirvāṇa, where all afflictions are dried up
and stilled,

contact with the nectar of deathlessness, remaining in the power of supernatural ability,
you who desire to manifest transformations —
come, listen to the Dharma of the Victors.
You who wish to become a pratyekabuddha or a śrāvaka,
or who wish, having tamed Māra with his forces and armies through power,
to become the supreme among two-footed beings, a buddha —
come as to the sovereign lord of Dharma.

Then, summoned by the elder Mahāmaudgalyāyana, many hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of billions of gods, sons of the gods of the desire realm and of the form realm, swiftly and quickly, from a great distance, carrying flowers, garlands of flowers, incense, and powdered perfumes, went to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, made offerings to the Blessed One, bowed with their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, and stood to one side. Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, having released that supernatural display, went to where the Blessed One was, arrived, and sat down in the presence of the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Mahāmaudgalyāyana, therefore listen carefully, take it to heart, and I shall set forth a category of Dharma called 'The Miraculous Display of the Tathāgata's Supernatural Power.'" "As the Blessed One commands," replied the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and he listened as the Blessed One directed. Then the Blessed One spoke these words:

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in this great trichiliocosm there are a hundred billion moons, a hundred billion suns, a hundred billion great oceans, a hundred billion of the king of mountains Mount Meru, and a hundred billion world-systems of the four great continents. This great trichiliocosm is the buddha-field of the buddhas. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, what do you think? If you were to suppose that I attained complete and perfect awakening only in this single world of the four great continents and nowhere else, Mahāmaudgalyāyana, you should not see it that way. Throughout all world-systems of the four great continents, I teach the Dharma in accordance with how beings are to be fully ripened: in some I have fully and completely awakened; in some I am still dwelling in a mother's womb; in some I am residing in Tuṣita heaven; and in some I have fully passed beyond sorrow — this I know truly.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in this very great trichiliocosm, in this very world-system of the four great continents, past twenty-two thousand world-systems of the four great continents to the east, there is a world-system of the four great continents called Dust-Free. There the Tathāgata, arhat, fully and completely awakened buddha named Dust-Free Intelligence is at this moment teaching the Dharma. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the sentient beings inhabiting that world-system of the four great continents have little attachment, little aversion, and little delusion; they are of good countenance and are purified by eloquent speech. There, those of the bodhisattva vehicle are few; the great majority follow the śrāvaka vehicle.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, with each teaching that the Tathāgata, arhat, fully and completely awakened, Dust-Free Intelligence, gives, he disciplines nine hundred and ninety million śrāvakas. There, the four fruits of the contemplative life — what are called stream-enterer (Skt. *srotaāpanna*), once-returner (Skt. *sakṛdāgāmin*), and non-returner (Skt. *anāgāmin*) — are not established there as distinct attainments; all of those disciples simply sit together on a single seat. Some directly actualize the supernatural knowledges, attain the eight liberations, obtain great gnosis, and then, having risen up into the sky to a height of seven palm-trees, they incinerate their own bodies with their own element of fire. Of those who have fully passed beyond sorrow, not even a trace of ash remains.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, thus that Tathāgata teaches the Dharma without interruption and liberates sentient beings, and without interruption śrāvakas pass fully beyond sorrow. There, there is neither giving nor receiving. Food, drink, and clothing arise by the mere power of thought, just as it is for the gods of the Thirty-Three. There, sentient beings are not born from a womb; they arise by spontaneous birth. The great earth there is also made of gold."

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in that world-realm of the Tathāgata Dustless Insight, the lifespan of those human beings is five hundred years, and there is no untimely death. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, what do you think? If you were to suppose that the Tathāgata called Dustless Insight who dwells in that world-realm is someone other than myself, Mahāmaudgalyāyana, you should not view it that way. Why? Because I myself teach the Dharma in that world-realm under that very name. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, this too is a miraculous display emanated through the buddha's supernatural power, and no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha whatsoever is capable of entering into it.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in this very great trichiliocosm, to the south, beyond eighty-eight thousand world-realms of the four great continents, there exists a world-realm of the four great continents called Source of Jewels, composed of four kinds of precious substance, namely gold, silver, crystal, and beryl. There, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Heap of Jewels is at this very moment teaching the Dharma. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, that Tathāgata teaches the Dharma chiefly for those of the pratyekabuddha vehicle. There, those of the śrāvaka vehicle are few, and those of the bodhisattva vehicle are few as well. Those sentient beings who belong to the pratyekabuddha vehicle, upon dying and passing from that world-realm, will be reborn in other empty buddha-fields, and by means of two conditions they will attain complete awakening. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, what do you think? If you were to suppose that the Tathāgata called Heap of Jewels who dwells in that world-realm is someone other than myself, Mahāmaudgalyāyana, you should not view it that way. Why? Because I myself teach the Dharma in that world-realm under that very name. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, this too is a miraculous display emanated through the buddha's supernatural power, and no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha whatsoever is capable of entering into it.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in this very great trichiliocosm, to the west, beyond twenty-two thousand world-realms of the four great continents, there exists a world-realm of the four great continents called Endowed with Manifold Jewels, composed of seven precious substances: gold, silver, lapis lazuli, crystal, beryl, red pearl, and coral. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in that world-realm there are promenades made of precious jewels, multi-storied mansions made of precious jewels, and lotus pools adorned with jeweled terraces. Food, drink, and clothing arise by the mere power of thought, just as the enjoyments and provisions of the gods of the Heaven of Joy are; so too are the enjoyments and provisions of the human beings who dwell in that world-realm. There, the very name of woman is unheard. There, there is no birth as a woman. There, those sentient beings do not engage in any conduct of sexual union. Those sentient beings do not entertain thoughts of desire, nor thoughts of ill will, nor thoughts of harm. There, no one dwells in a womb; those sentient beings arise by spontaneous birth and appear seated cross-legged. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in that world-realm called Endowed with Manifold Jewels, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Source of Jewels is at this very moment teaching the Dharma."

He teaches no discourse other than that endowed with the six perfections — the diamond-word-wheel of the three cycles of the dhāraṇī, the category of Dharma known as the Bodhisattva's Scriptural Treasury — being wholly complete and unbroken. There, immeasurable and uncountable sentient beings generate the mind of awakening directed toward unsurpassed, perfect, and complete enlightenment. Immeasurable and uncountable sentient beings attain the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anūpattikadharmakṣānti). Immeasurable and uncountable sentient beings receive the prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete enlightenment. There, the two vehicles — the vehicle of the śrāvakas and the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas — are not established at all. That world-realm of the four great continents is entirely filled by bodhisattvas alone, free from the stench of wrongdoing and untouched by sexual union. The lifespan of that Tathāgata endures for eighty-four thousand years. Among those people there is untimely death, yet no sentient being who passes away from there is ever born in a hell, in an animal realm, in the world of Yama, or among the states of deprivation. Most of those bodhisattvas, upon passing away from there, are reborn in other perfectly pure buddha-fields, and come face to face with the Tathāgatas. In those continents, whatever gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas (dri za) there are — all of them share one and the same mind and understanding, directed toward omniscience. Those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas delight in nothing other than the Dharma of the buddhas; they do not give rise to delight in anything else. As for those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, and humans, the designations "god," "nāga," "gandharva," and "human" exist only as names; beyond that there is no distinction or division among them.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, what do you think? Do you suppose that the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Source of Jewels who is teaching the Dharma in that world-realm is someone other?"

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, you should not see it that way. Why is that? It is I myself who teach the Dharma in that world-realm under that very name. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, this too is a wondrous display (nirmāṇa) produced by the miraculous power of a buddha; it is not something easily known in full by all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, from this very trichiliocosm — this great world-realm of the three-thousandfold universe — passing beyond thirty-six thousand world-realms of the four great continents in the northern direction, there exists a world-realm of the four great continents called Fearless, made of two

precious materials — gold and silver. There, there is no terror of the hells; there is no terror of the animal realm; there is no terror of the world of Yama; there is no terror of the states of deprivation; there is no terror of the lower destinies. There, no sentient being has fallen from moral discipline, nor has fallen from right view, nor has fallen from proper conduct. There, not even the names of other tīrthikas or wandering ascetics are given.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in that world-realm called Fearless, there is at this very moment a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Bestower of Fearlessness who is teaching the Dharma. Mahāmaudgalyāyana, that Tathāgata teaches the Dharma to sentient beings by way of the three vehicles — the vehicle leading to becoming a śrāvaka, the vehicle leading to becoming a pratyekabuddha, and the vehicle leading to becoming a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha.

"Mahāmaudgalyāyana,

that Tathāgata, at the time when he wishes to go to the seat of awakening in order to attain complete and perfect enlightenment, and while he is sitting at the seat of awakening — at that time seventy-two koṭis of māras, headed by a māra called Good Intelligence, will come. At that time the Tathāgata, who is still a bodhisattva and has not yet attained omniscience, will magically create as many awakening-trees as there are māras. And as many awakening-trees as there are, that many magically emanated bodhisattvas, each seated at his own awakening-tree, will appear. Seeing this, those māras will be filled with amazement and wonder: "Who is the true bodhisattva? Which one shall we obstruct?" Then those emanated bodhisattvas will speak these words to those māras: "Friends, since all phenomena are like illusions, how could you obstruct this one? Moreover, do you know how much merit will accrue to one who arouses the mind set on unsurpassed, complete, and perfect enlightenment, or to one who causes another to genuinely enter and embrace it? You do not understand even that. If you knew how much demerit would accrue from obstructing one who has entered the bodhisattva vehicle, you would not apply yourselves to causing obstruction."

Then the māras said: "How much merit does one generate by arousing the mind set on unsurpassed, complete, and perfect enlightenment, or by causing another to understand and genuinely enter into it?"

The emanated bodhisattvas replied: "Friends, if someone were to fill buddha-fields as numerous as the grains of sand of the Ganges River with

precious jewels and give them as gifts — one who arouses the mind set on unsurpassed, complete, and perfect enlightenment generates far more merit than that. Friends, if someone were to honor all sentient beings as numerous as the grains of sand of the Ganges River with every kind of pleasant requisite for a hundred thousand eons — one who causes another to understand and genuinely enter into it generates far more merit than that."

Those māras then said: "How much demerit does one generate by obstructing a bodhisattva from unsurpassed, complete, and perfect enlightenment?"

The emanated bodhisattvas replied: "How much demerit would be generated by plucking out the eyes of all those sentient beings?"

The māras said: "An enormous amount."

The bodhisattvas said: "One who obstructs a bodhisattva from unsurpassed, complete, and perfect enlightenment generates far more demerit than even that."

Then, upon receiving this instruction and witnessing such a miraculous display, all those māras without exception aroused the mind set on unsurpassed, complete, and perfect enlightenment. All the emanated bodhisattvas were showered with divine flowers, garlands, and perfumes. A thousand musical instruments resounded together, and these words rang out: "Great captain, may you swiftly, swiftly attain complete and perfect unsurpassed enlightenment — and after that, may we too be established in enlightenment, we beseech you!" And other gods raised their voices and cried: "Ah, how wonderful! These māras, by having aroused the mind set on unsurpassed, complete, and perfect enlightenment, are fully liberated from all fears of the lower realms. Ah, how wonderful — this Tathāgata is indeed the Bestower of Fearlessness!

"Therefore, this Tathāgata's name shall be Bestower of Fearlessness, Bestower of Fearlessness" — so they cried out.

"Son of Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? Do you suppose that the Tathāgata who teaches the Dharma to those sentient beings in that world-realm is someone other?" Son of Maudgalyāyana, you should not see it that way. Why? Because it is I myself who taught the Dharma in that world-realm under that very name. Son of Maudgalyāyana, this too is a miraculous display, a magical transformation wrought by the buddha's supernatural power — something that no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha is

capable of entering into.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, from within this very great trichiliocosm world-realm, in the direction between east and south, beyond eighty-four thousand world-realms of four great continents, there exists a world-realm of four great continents called Variegated. There, a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Variegated Flowers teaches the Dharma.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, that world-realm of four great continents is brilliant and beautiful to behold, a delight to the eye, covered over with nets of jewels, and carpeted throughout with soft blue grass pleasant to the touch — like kācalinḍika — growing to the height of about four finger-breadths. That great earth, when one lifts one's foot, yields with a sound, and when one sets it down, yields again with a sound; that great earth is level as the palm of a hand.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, in that world-realm called Variegated there is a great city named Suśreṣṭhā — prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with fine harvests, delightful, thronged with people and a great multitude of folk. From its eastern side to the western river it extends thirty-two leagues, and from south to north it is twelve leagues in breadth.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, within that great city of Suśreṣṭhā there dwell sentient beings in the greatest numbers — nothing like those in the lands of Aṅga, Magadha, and Kuru.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, thus the Tathāgata Variegated Flowers, dwelling and residing in that great city of Suśreṣṭhā, by a single teaching of the Dharma brought thirty koṭi times one hundred thousand sentient beings to the state of arhatship; brought thirty koṭi times one hundred thousand to the fruit of non-return; brought thirty koṭi times one hundred thousand to the fruit of once-return; brought thirty koṭi times one hundred thousand to the fruit of stream-entry; brought thirty koṭi times one hundred thousand to full maturation in the awakening of pratyekabuddhas. Twice that number aroused the mind set on unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening. And beyond that still, he fully ripened the roots of virtue of immeasurable sentient beings.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, in that world-realm of four great continents there are groves of trees called Honey-Source that are perpetually in flower and perpetually in fruit. The taste of those flowers and fruits is like that of fruits combined with a hundred flavors. If a man or a woman there eats a single flower or a single fruit, it will sustain them for seven days and nights; their

vitality and complexion will not diminish, and they will experience their bodies as resplendent with brilliant luster and fine color, and their hunger will be appeased. Moreover, after eating there is no defecation or urination, no phlegm and no mucus. In that world-realm there is no plowing of fields, no trading, no accounting, no labor — those sentient beings subsist on those flowers and fruits. There, there are neither rich nor poor;

Those sentient beings are equal in their enjoyments. O son of Maudgalyāyana, the Śrāvaka Saṅgha of that Tathāgata numbers ninety-nine hundred thousands. That Tathāgata resides in a pleasure grove called Flowers in Full Bloom. When the Blessed One dwells there together with the Śrāvaka Saṅgha and midday arrives, the trees in that place bow down, and those flowers and fruits pour themselves into the alms bowls of the Blessed One and the monks. Knowing that the meal has been received, those trees straighten back up again and stand as before. O son of Maudgalyāyana, such are the qualities of that world-realm, and there are yet more beyond even these.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? Do you suppose, or have any doubt, or entertain any uncertainty that the Tathāgata who teaches the Dharma to those sentient beings in that world-realm is someone other? You would not think so. And why? Because it is I myself who teach the Dharma in that world-realm under the name Endowed with Manifold Flowers. O son of Maudgalyāyana, this too is a miraculous display, a transformation wrought through the miraculous powers of a buddha — something that no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha whatsoever is able to enter into.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, in the direction between south and west of this very great trichiliocosm, beyond seventy thousand world-realms of the four great continents, there is a world-realm of the four great continents called Discerning Intelligence. In a single continent of that world there are eighty thousand kings. Each single continent also has eighty thousand cities and eighty thousand market towns. All those villages, cities, towns, districts, and markets are completely filled with hundreds of millions of humans. All those kings are content with their respective kingdoms. All those kings are righteous kings who have wholly abandoned what is contrary to the Dharma. Each of those kings also has eighty-four thousand royal consorts and women, and all those women are exclusively the finest in the land. Each king also has five hundred sons. Each king also has twenty-two thousand daughters, and all of them are exclusively the finest in the land. All those kings discipline those subject to them without punishment and without weapons.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, in that world-realm called Discerning Intelligence, a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha by the name Radiantly Spreading Rays of Light teaches the Dharma. O son of Maudgalyāyana, that Tathāgata, having fully and perfectly awakened to the unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, rose up into the sky above that world-realm of the four great continents to a height of about seven tāla trees, and seated there in cross-legged posture, filling that entire world-realm of the four great continents with a single cross-legged posture, he spreads forth rays of light, rains down showers of flowers, sounds hundreds and thousands of musical instruments, and causes the great earth to tremble in six ways. Then, with a voice like the sound of Brahmā — a voice that has been perfectly accomplished through countless hundreds of thousands of roots of virtue — he turns the wheel of Dharma: that is to say, he fully reveals the stainless nirvāṇa for the exhaustion of all afflictions, and he teaches the Dharma in order to gather bodhisattvas.

Through that teaching of the Dharma, eighty thousand kings of the world-realm of the four great continents, together with their sons, their queens, and their daughters — as well as all other men, women, boys, and girls apart from those kings and their families — gained the pure and stainless Dharma eye (dharmacakṣus) with respect to all phenomena.

Those kings, together with their sons, queens, and daughters, then aroused the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and all of them with one voice implored the Tathāgata to grant them the going forth. All of them, at the Tathāgata's words "Come here, monks," went forth into homelessness.

Having thus all gone forth, they dwelt in their respective villages, towns, hamlets, districts, market-places, and royal palaces, sustained by their own requisites. Unharvested and unsown, crops of rice arose of themselves. The gods, too, paid them homage and reverence.

Then, at the second Dharma-teaching of that Tathāgata, all those of the śrāvaka vehicle were established in the fruit of the once-returner. Those of the bodhisattva vehicle were established in the acceptance that phenomena do not arise.

At the third Dharma-teaching, those of the śrāvaka vehicle were established in the fruit of the non-returner. Those of the bodhisattva vehicle attained the five superknowledges (abhijñā).

At the fourth Dharma-teaching, all those of the śrāvaka vehicle were established in arhatship itself. Those of the bodhisattva vehicle attained the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti).

As for those royal queens, those princes, and those royal princesses: in those very bodies, transforming away from female bodies, they obtained male bodies, and every one of them was given a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening by that Tathāgata.

Now, son of Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? Do you suppose that the Tathāgata who taught the Dharma in that world-realm was someone other? Son of Maudgalyāyana, you should not view it that way. Why is that? It was I myself who taught the Dharma in that world-realm, bearing that very name.

This also was a miraculous display manifested through the miraculous power of a buddha — something into which no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha whatsoever can enter.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, passing fifty-five thousand world-realms of the four great continents from this very great trichiliocosm, in the direction between west and north, there exists a world-realm of the four great continents called Endowed with Fragrance. There is found there nothing but the heartwood of sandalwood serpents, and one weight-unit of that fragrance is worth an entire Jambudvīpa.

There too are trees called Fragrance Rising from All Sides, and from a single tree the scent of that fragrance spreads for ten leagues in every direction around it.

There, from the great earth, lotus flowers rise up to the height of a chariot wheel, bearing hundreds of thousands of petals and hundreds of thousands of hues, soft and pleasant to the touch like fine kacāliṇḍika cloth, and standing about ten cubits tall; and the scent of each single lotus fills that world-realm of the four great continents with a sweet and pleasant fragrance.

In that world-realm of the four great continents, sandalwood mansions rise in tiers, and their sandalwood promenades are filled with lotus flowers and blossoms. Hundreds of thousands of tiered mansions pervade that world-realm entirely. There are no separate villages or towns to be governed, for the manner of life there is like the enjoyment of the gods who rule over the emanations of others —

just as their enjoyments are, so too in that world-realm the conduct and enjoyments of those people are just like that.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, in that world-realm called Fragrant, the Tathāgata named Radiant Rays of Fragrance is at this very moment teaching the Dharma. That Tathāgata has entirely abandoned all discourse suited to śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and speaks exclusively of what pertains to bodhisattvas.

That world-realm of the four great continents is filled entirely with bodhisattvas, great beings, each and every one of whom has attained supernatural power. In that bodhisattva assembly there is present a bodhisattva named King of Magical Displays in All Phenomena, who is endowed with inconceivable engagement, who has attained the second patient acceptance, who is skilled in the higher knowledges, who has penetrated understanding through eloquence, and who has served and honored many hundreds of thousands of millions of buddhas.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, that Tathāgata urged and gave occasion to the bodhisattva King of Magical Displays in All Phenomena to teach the Dharma. And so, in the presence of the Blessed One, that bodhisattva rose from his seat, prostrated at the feet of the Tathāgata, circumambulated the Tathāgata three times, then rose up into the space above, extending his cross-legged posture to fill a circle of ten leagues in every direction. From every single one of his pores he sent forth rays of light, suffusing all world-realms with that radiance. Then he scattered hundreds of thousands of multicolored flowers, each the size of a chariot wheel, spreading them just knee-high across that great earth. And throughout all world-realms there arose the sound of divine and human musical instruments. From those musical instruments came eight hundred sounds of Dharma-seals, and each single Dharma-seal comprised eighty-four thousand sūtras, and each single sūtra was expressed in seventy-two thousand verses.

Without rising from that cross-legged posture, he established ninety-six billion hundred-thousand-million sentient beings in irreversibility from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and caused them all to attain the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, that world-realm is filled with bodhisattvas such as these. In that realm there are no sentient beings who are thin, bloated, diseased, blind, poor, or of ugly complexion. All those sentient beings are

exclusively bodhisattvas endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great being. Those sentient beings delight in nothing whatsoever other than the joy of Dharmic delight. And for those bodhisattvas, those great beings, there is no food other than the nourishment of the joy of meditative concentration. In that realm there is no falling into states of misfortune or birth in unfree conditions. And when beings pass away from there, they go nowhere other than into a destiny in the presence of a Tathāgata.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? Do you suppose that the Tathāgata named Radiant Rays of Fragrance, who dwells in that world-realm, is someone other? O son of Maudgalyāyana, you should not think so. The reason is this: it is I myself who, known by that name, teaches the Dharma to beings in that world-realm. O son of Maudgalyāyana, this too is a magical display, a transformation through the supernatural power of a buddha, and into it no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha whatsoever is able to enter.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, from this very great trichilocosm, in the direction at the boundary between north and east, beyond forty-two thousand world-realms of the four great continents —

there exists a world-realm of four great continents called Overcome by Grief. The sentient beings who dwell there are overwhelmed by attachment, burning with aversion, confused by delusion, full of craving, full of covetousness, given to agitation, prone to idle chatter, weak in their faculties, miserly, morally corrupt, greatly malicious, slothful, indolent, forgetful, without vigilance, holding to a view of self, holding to views of a being, a life-force, and a person, possessed of wrong wisdom, dull as sheep, shameless, impudent, without reverence, and thoroughly deluded in mind. Those sentient beings are entirely of bad complexion, of ill repute, ugly in appearance, living with difficulty, and subsisting by preying on one another. In that place rain does not fall for six months, and crops do not ripen well. That great earth is rough, hard, covered with various thorns, full of ravines and rocky crags. In that world-realm the water of those sentient beings is like the dregs and sediment of oil. Those sentient beings are utterly destitute and impoverished with respect to clothing, religious robes, and possessions, and they live entirely by stealing the wealth of others. In that world-realm there is a king called Hatred and Desire, who exercises lordly power over those sentient beings and causes all their wealth and grain to be drawn into the royal treasury. Those sentient beings are oppressed by nothing other than punishments and beatings. O son of Maudgalyāyana, these are the sufferings of that world-realm in that life. And

when those beings die, most are reborn in the hells, in the realms of animal birth, and in the world of Yama, lord of the dead.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, in that world-realm of four great continents, a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Loving and Compassionate Mind teaches the Dharma. O son of Maudgalyāyana, that Tathāgata teaches the Dharma through eighteen kinds of magical display. Although he taught the Dharma for seven hundred years, not a single sentient being came to a direct realization of the Dharma, and yet that Tathāgata, far from being discouraged, continued to teach the Dharma with great compassion.

O son of Maudgalyāyana, that Tathāgata dwells and resides in villages, cities, and towns, and though those sentient beings blocked his almsround routes with thorns and branches, reviling and mocking him, still he bore it all with great compassion for the sake of ripening those sentient beings toward full maturity. O son of Maudgalyāyana, in a span exceeding seven hundred years, that Tathāgata fully ripened certain sentient beings; and at a single teaching of the Dharma, eighty-four trillion sentient beings attained the state of arhat, eighty-four trillion attained the fruit of non-returner, eighty-four trillion attained the fruit of once-returner, and eighty-four trillion attained the fruit of stream-enterer, and these last ones all went forth into renunciation and received full ordination on that very same day. All of those trainees and those beyond training, through mutual prophetic announcements to one another, passed into complete nirvāṇa within a single day. That Tathāgata was born there as a bodhisattva through the obstruction of karma, and he continues to remain there still for the purpose of fully ripening those beings who experience feelings of suffering.

When the Blessed One had thus spoken, the venerable Mahā-Maudgalyāyana addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, through what karmic obstruction is it that bodhisattvas are born, for a time, in an afflicted world-realm?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of Maudgala, if a bodhisattva possesses four qualities, he will, for a time, take rebirth in a lower state. What are the four? Son of Maudgala, a bodhisattva who makes his living by means of the name 'bodhisattva' while not training in the bodhisattva trainings; son of Maudgala, furthermore, a bodhisattva who abandons the sacred Dharma, casting it away and not turning back to it; son of Maudgala, furthermore, a bodhisattva who

creates obstacles to the material support of other bodhisattvas and speaks disparagingly of them; and son of Maudgala, furthermore, a bodhisattva who is possessed of unguarded actions of body, speech, and mind. Son of Maudgala, if a bodhisattva possesses these four qualities, he will, for a time, go to the lower destinies.

Son of Maudgala, what do you think? Do you suppose that the Tathāgata who resides in that world-realm, called 'the one who contemplates love and compassion,' is someone other than myself? Son of Maudgala, you should not see it that way. Why is that? It is I myself who, under that name, teaches the Dharma to sentient beings in that world-realm. Son of Maudgala, this too is a miraculous display, a manifestation wrought by the supernatural power of a buddha, and into this no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha whatsoever is able to enter.

Son of Maudgala, in this way the Tathāgata performs the enlightened activity of a buddha throughout all the world-realms of the great trichiliocosm. Into this you śrāvakas are not able to enter unless the Teacher has shown it to you.

Son of Maudgala, in this great trichiliocosm there are one hundred billion world-realms of the four great continents, and in them the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma to sentient beings in accordance with each one's aspiration. Son of Maudgala, in this very great trichiliocosm there are world-realms of the four great continents in which I teach the Dharma in the form of Brahmā, without showing the Tathāgata going forth into renunciation or wearing the saffron robe. Likewise, I also teach the Dharma in the form of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods). Likewise, I teach the Dharma in every kind of birth. Son of Maudgala, throughout all these world-realms of the great trichiliocosm I teach the Dharma to sentient beings of every kind of aspiration, in accordance with their aspiration. I also teach the Dharma in immeasurable other buddha-fields, and into this no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha whatsoever is able to enter.

Son of Maudgala, consider this example: the disc of the moon or the disc of the sun does not move from its place in the sky, and yet it appears correctly in every village, town, hamlet, district, and royal palace. Son of Maudgala, in just the same way, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha does not move from his own buddha-field, and yet he appears correctly in immeasurable buddha-fields and teaches the Dharma to sentient beings as each of them has fully ripened."

Then the venerable Mahā-Maudgalyāyana addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, those who dwell in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and Jambudvīpa, and the abodes of the gods —"

"In this great trichiliocosm, and in the other and yet other world-systems of the four great continents, who is the true Tathāgata dwelling there and teaching the Dharma? And how am I to seek out the true Tathāgata upon whom offerings should be made if one wishes to gain great power?" When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One addressed the venerable Mahā-Maudgalyāyana with these words:

"Son of Maudgala, that is precisely why I put the question back to you. Answer it as you see fit. Son of Maudgala, what do you think? In a man or a woman conjured up by a magician, what is real? What is true?"

He replied: "Blessed One, in that there is nothing whatsoever that is real or true. Why is that? Because the magician produces the power of his secret mantras and knowledge-mantras and thereby causes the emanation to emanate — there is therefore nothing distinctive about them at all."

The Blessed One said: "Son of Maudgala, does that emanation nonetheless perform its activities?"

He replied: "Blessed One, it does."

The Blessed One said: "Son of Maudgala, in exactly the same way, among all phenomena that are like illusions there is no distinction, no differentiation, no separation. Son of Maudgala, just as a magician, by the power of his secret mantras and knowledge-mantras, produces many emanations, and all of those emanations are equal and without distinction, in the very same way, Son of Maudgala, the Tathāgata, through wisdom, knowledge, and gnosis, appears as the Teacher in all buddha-fields, and all those appearances are likewise equal and without distinction — they perform the buddha's enlightened activity, and for those who make offerings to them the karmic ripening is equally the same. Son of Maudgala, among the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, there is not even the slightest distinction or separation. Son of Maudgala, therefore all phenomena that are untrue and that have become like illusions are, within the dharmadhātu, without distinction, without differentiation, without separation.

"Son of Maudgala, should the Tathāgata so wish, he can emanate, in a single world-system, as many Tathāgatas possessing the thirty-two marks and endowed with the very nature and physical stature of that Tathāgata as there

are grains of sand in the Ganges River — and all of those teach the Dharma through the activity of speech endowed with sixty qualities. All those Tathāgatas know the mental conduct of every sentient being. All those Tathāgatas teach the Dharma in order to give rise in sentient beings to cognition that enters in accordance with their aspiration and with the nature of their faculties. Through the teaching of the Dharma by all those Tathāgatas, various sentient beings come to definite emergence, and in order thereby to bring suffering to a thorough end, all those Tathāgatas teach the Dharma through the four kinds of miraculous display. All those Tathāgatas also perfectly reveal all the qualities of a buddha.

"Son of Maudgala, what do you think? Among them, which one is the most excellent, the most endowed with form, the most endowed with beauty, the most endowed with confidence, the most endowed with gnosis, the most endowed with miraculous powers, the most endowed with Dharma-teaching, the most endowed with the liberation of sentient beings?"

He replied: "Blessed One, it is impossible to point to any difference among them."

The Blessed One said: "Son of Maudgala, therefore, through this very reasoning too, all phenomena are of the essential nature of emanation — without distinction, without differentiation, without separation. Understand it thus. Son of Maudgala, those who know all phenomena as being of the essential nature of emanation would not wish to differentiate them even with respect to ordinary beings — what need is there to say this of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones? Why is that?"

"Son of Maudgala, all phenomena are empty by intrinsic nature. They arise from imputation and complete conceptual construction. Though one may fully demonstrate them just as one wishes, the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, neither arises nor ceases.

Son of Maudgala, that dharmadhātu the Tathāgata knows directly and fully. Because he has known it thus, the Tathāgata, from a single hair pore, perfectly manifests himself together with the Saṅgha of monks before each and every one of all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa, as many as they are — and yet none of them knows the other.

Son of Maudgala, let alone Jambudvīpa — before all the sentient beings, as many as there are, dwelling in their respective places of birth throughout the world systems of the four great continents, whether gods, humans, or others

of every kind, the Tathāgata, from a single hair pore, perfectly manifests himself together with the Saṅgha of monks before every one of them — and yet none of them knows the other.

Son of Maudgala, let alone the sentient beings of the world systems of the four great continents — to press the example further: suppose all the sentient beings gathered within the trichiliocosm, the great world system of three thousand times three thousand worlds, were, all of them together and simultaneously, to obtain human bodies. The Tathāgata, from a single hair pore, perfectly manifests himself together with the Saṅgha of monks before each and every one of those beings who have thus become human — and yet none of them knows the other.

Son of Maudgala, let alone all the sentient beings of the great trichiliocosm — Son of Maudgala, to press the example yet further: in the eastern direction, in as many world systems as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā river, the realm of sentient beings spoken of there is exceedingly vast, while the realm of earth is not like that. Likewise to the south, the west, the north, the intermediate directions, below and above — throughout all ten directions, in each and every direction, in as many world systems as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā river, the realm of sentient beings spoken of there is exceedingly vast, while the realm of earth is not like that.

Son of Maudgala, to press the example still further: even if every one of those sentient beings were simultaneously to obtain human bodies, the Tathāgata, from a single hair pore, would perfectly manifest himself together with the Saṅgha of monks before each and every one of all those sentient beings — and yet none of them would know the other.

Son of Maudgala, let alone the sentient beings dwelling in world systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā river throughout the ten directions — Son of Maudgala, the Tathāgata, while remaining on this very seat, beholds with the unobstructed, unimpeded eye of a buddha all the buddha-fields, however many there are. Even I could not easily recount them fully, taking a hundred thousand aeons as examples drawn in succession, all the while with the wisdom of a buddha undiminished — so immeasurable beyond measure are those buddha-fields. What I behold while remaining on this seat, and what the Tathāgata has shown by means of the examples enumerated — even if all sentient beings were to become like pratyekabuddhas, solitary buddhas, they could not easily know, measure, or

fathom it; how much less then could śrāvakas, hearers. Only a Tathāgata can know how many hundreds of buddha-fields there are, how many thousands, how many hundreds of thousands —"

— how many hundreds of thousands of tens of millions there are, how many hundreds of thousands of myriads there are, how many hundreds of thousands of koṭis there are, how many hundreds of thousands of immovables there are, how many hundreds of thousands of innumerable there are, how many hundreds of thousands of immeasurables there are, how many hundreds of thousands equal to the grains of sand of the Ganges there are, how many hundreds of thousands equal to the finest dust-motes filling the great thousandfold world system there are — all this he knows.

Son of Maudgalyāyana, with the unobstructed and unimpeded eye of a buddha, seeing however many buddha-fields there are, the assemblage of sentient beings gathered together in those buddha-fields and reckoned as sentient beings is exceedingly vast in number, yet the element of those lands is not of that same measure. If all those sentient beings were to obtain a human body, one after another without interval, and having obtained it were to become wheel-turning kings (cakravartins), and if each such wheel-turning king were attended by a retinue of that same magnitude — even so, son of Maudgalyāyana, the Tathāgata would, from a single hair-pore, manifest before each of those wheel-turning kings together with their retinues the Tathāgata surrounded by a Saṅgha of monks, and not one among them would know the other, each beholding his own Tathāgata. Likewise, from every single hair-pore the Tathāgata would manifest surrounded by a Saṅgha of monks — and yet even that would not constitute a hundredth part, not a thousandth part, not a hundred-thousandth part, not a ten-million-hundred-thousandth part, not a fraction, not a portion, not a counting, not a likeness, not even a cause of the miraculous display that is the Tathāgata's display of supernatural power. Son of Maudgalyāyana, thus it is that the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, is endowed with immeasurable supernatural power and immeasurable gnosis (jñāna).

Son of Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? Is the accumulation of merit of those sentient beings who have become wheel-turners — the accumulation of merit gained through the sovereign dominion of the wheel-turning king and through obtaining the seven precious things — is that accumulation of merit great? He addressed the Blessed One: "It is great, Blessed One. It is immeasurable, O Sugata." The Blessed One declared: Son of Maudgalyāyana,

you should have faith in this; you should take it to heart. The accumulation of merit still more vast than the accumulated merit of all those sentient beings who have become wheel-turners is what perfects a single hair-pore of the Tathāgata.

Then the venerable Maudgalyāyana the Great said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I have found well what I have found, in that my Teacher is possessed of such great supernatural power, of such great renown, of such great might. And yet, though this be so, I have fallen inferior to a gnosis such as this — the unobstructed gnosis that follows after causes in all phenomena. Blessed One, how much more, then, have those sentient beings found well what they have found, who, upon hearing this miraculous display that is the Tathāgata's display of the supernatural power of a buddha, have even once aroused the mind of awakening — and who, having faith and trust, arouse it and, believing, will perfect supernatural power and gnosis such as this by generating the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Those sentient beings are worthy of veneration by the world together with its gods."

The Blessed One declared: Son of Maudgalyāyana, it is so; it is exactly as you say. Sentient beings who have faith in the qualities of the Tathāgata have indeed found well what they have found. Know that for them there is no fear of falling into error.

Then those gods, those nāgas, those Śakras (Indra),

those Brahmās, having heard from the Blessed One this wondrous display of magical transformation wrought through the supernatural power of the buddhas, spoke in unison and bowed down to the blessed buddhas, saying: "Homage! Homage!" And to those sentient beings who have aroused or will arouse the mind of awakening in order to perfect such gnosis as this, they likewise bowed down, saying: "Homage!" And they made this solemn declaration: "Just as the Tathāgata performs magical transformations now, so too will those beings perform magical transformations. Therefore we should have no doubt, no uncertainty, no hesitation about this."

Then those gods, those nāgas, those yakṣas, those gandharvas, those Śakras, and those Brahmās, in order to pay homage to the Blessed One and to honor this teaching of the Dharma, released the sound of a hundred thousand cymbals all at once. And they scattered divine flowers — blue lotuses, red lotuses, kumuda water-lilies, and white lotuses — throughout all the realms of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

As this teaching of the Dharma was being expounded, seventy-two hundred thousand myriads of gods who had not previously aroused the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening aroused it, and spoke these words: "Just as the Tathāgata now roars the lion's roar, so may we too, in time to come, roar the unsurpassed lion's roar before the world together with its gods."

Then the divine sons Candra and Candrottama addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how much merit will be generated by any son or daughter of good family who holds, retains, reads, thoroughly masters, and extensively and correctly teaches to others this teaching of the Dharma?"

When they had spoken thus, the Blessed One replied to the divine sons Candra and Candrottama: "Divine sons, any son or daughter of good family who both retains this teaching of the Dharma themselves and teaches it to others — know that such a person abides in order to ensure the unbroken continuity of the Three Jewels. And why is that? Divine sons, upon hearing this teaching of the Dharma, one will not arouse the mind of a śrāvaka or the mind of a pratyekabuddha; one will arouse the mind of awakening for nothing less than unsurpassed, perfect, and complete enlightenment. And why is that? Divine sons, those of keen faculties who are devoted to the vast and who have previously served the Victors with dedication — they will give rise to joy in this teaching of the Dharma, while those devoted to lesser things will not. Divine sons, know then, by this enumeration, that those who retain and read this teaching of the Dharma abide so that the continuity of the Three Jewels may not be severed.

"Divine sons, what do you think? Even if a hundred thousand buddhas were to remain alive for an eon and were to speak in praise of that person who abides to ensure the unbroken continuity of the Three Jewels — could the bounds of that praise or the bounds of that merit be expressed or expounded?"

"Blessed One, they could not."

The Blessed One declared: "Divine sons, know then by this enumeration that whoever retains this teaching of the Dharma or teaches it to others will generate immeasurable merit."

Then the bodhisattva Maitreya (Loving-Kindness) addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the name of this teaching of the Dharma? How should we hold it?"

The Blessed One declared: "Maitreya, hold this teaching of the Dharma under the name 'The Chapter of the Thirty-Three.' Hold it also under the name 'The Wondrous Display of Magical Transformation Wrought Through the Supernatural Power of the Buddhas.'"

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the divine son Zla ba, the divine son Zla mchog, the great bodhisattva Maitreya, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, those Brahmās, those Śākras (Indras), and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and gave great praise to what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

Thus is the Mahāyāna sūtra entitled "The Noble Chapter of the Thirty-Three" complete.

This was translated by the Indian master Prajñāvarman and the great editor

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "flat stone like a harmonium" translates a simile comparing the stone to an armonīka (harmonium or similar flat-board instrument); this is a standard Sanskrit loanword in Tibetan canonical texts and refers to a broad, flat slab. Some editions gloss this differently, but the flat-stone-as-musical-instrument-board comparison is the received reading.

The phrase "medicine for themselves and medicine for other sentient beings" refers to the dual purpose of the bodhisattva path: benefiting oneself and others; the Tibetan རྒྱུ་སྐྱོད་ཀྱི་སྨན་པར་གྲོགས་པའི་སྨན་པ་ is literally "entered for the sake of medicine for self and medicine for other sentient beings."

The verse line rendered "who observe proper conduct without the flaw of pretense" translates 眞實無偽の徳を修むる者, where 眞實無偽の徳 is a somewhat compressed phrase; the reading adopted understands it as referring to the fault of merely performing or feigning proper conduct, which is absent in these beings.

- The phrase rendered "legs of miraculous power" translates the Tibetan for the four bases of miraculous power (rdzu 'phrul rkang pa), one of the standard sets in the Dharma, though here abbreviated to a single compound; no doctrinal distortion results from the rendering chosen.

The closing of the prose section ends mid-sentence in the source, as the passage itself breaks off; the translation reflects this faithfully.

- The passage contains a subtle interplay between two related Yogācāra and Madhyamaka frameworks: the "mind-only" statement that the three realms are nothing but mind, followed immediately by a deconstruction in which even that mind cannot be found. This is a classical move in texts that synthesize Yogācāra and Madhyamaka, and the translation preserves the tension rather than resolving it. The phrase rendered "stirred into motion by the stirring of the self" (bdag nyid kyi kun nas slong bas) is idiomatically dense; it describes how the reifying sense of self is the root motivating force that activates or arouses phenomena into apparent existence, and mindfulness meditation penetrates this mechanism.
- The phrase rendered "does not rely on another's instruction" translates "gzhan gyi dring mi 'jog pa'i shes pa," which more literally means "knowledge that does not place itself at another's behest" or "knowledge independent of external authority." The rendering captures the

doctrinal sense: direct knowledge that is self-validating and requires no secondhand transmission.

- The phrase rendered "the nose does not see what the eye sees" and the lines that follow present a catalogue of the mutual non-interference of the sense faculties. The Tibetan "nams" in those lines is an archaic or contracted form used as a general object marker for perception; the sense is that each faculty is confined to its own domain and perceives nothing of the others' domains.

The phrase "without activity, without doing, inert" translates "spyod med byed pa med la bems po ste," where "bems po" literally means something rigid or inert, here suggesting that phenomena of the dharmadhātu are utterly without inherent activity or agency — a point about their equipoise with emptiness. This reading is doctrinally standard but the word "bems po" applied in this metaphysical sense is worth noting.

- The final sentence is syntactically incomplete, ending mid-construction as the passage breaks off. This is consistent with the text continuing beyond the given excerpt.
- The phrase rendered "sustains life by drawing on whatever is the essence of their teaching" translates a somewhat compressed construction meaning that the bodhisattva does not aspire to those vehicles but nonetheless nourishes themselves spiritually on whatever genuine content those paths contain. This is a standard Mahāyāna motif of skillful engagement without aspiring to the lesser goals.

The line "unsupported meditative concentration" renders the Tibetan for concentration without a referential support or object of fixation, a technical Mahāyāna usage.

- The phrase rendered "level and even, without fabrication" translates the Tibetan "ya ma bra ste byed pa med," which uses a term suggesting things are equal and flat like a plain or level ground — conveying the non-hierarchical, unelaborated nature of all conditioned phenomena. This is a somewhat unusual expression and the rendering attempts to capture both the leveling and the non-activity implied.
- The line rendered "patience is one thing, and desire is another thing no more" reflects a difficult passage. The Tibetan reads literally that patience is for something other, and desire is for something other — suggesting that in the face of universal emptiness, neither patience nor desire finds any valid object, as both presuppose a referent that emptiness dissolves. The precise syntax is somewhat compressed and this interpretation follows the doctrinal logic of the context.

The color-designation passage, listing blue, yellow, red, white, crimson, and crystal-colored, appears to be a standard formula in the sūtra literature for demonstrating that karma and moral action have no perceptible, material, or cognitive referent — reinforcing the unconditioned nature of authentic moral discipline.

- [illegible]

The final verse line is incomplete in the source passage as given, ending mid-stanza with "One whose moral discipline is like that — fearless —"; this reflects the supplied text cutting off at that point.

- The phrase "the three aspects likewise" in the verse section renders "bdag dang de bzhin rnam gsum," which likely refers to self, moral discipline, and degraded moral discipline as a triad — the point being that without perceiving any of these three as ultimately real, the very distinction between discipline and its violation dissolves. This is a doctrinally significant nuance.

The phrase "brings forth many precious jewels" renders "dkon mchog mang po 'byung bar byed," literally "causes many Three Jewels to arise," meaning the bodhisattva's practice ensures the continuation of buddha, Dharma, and Saṅgha in the world — a deliberate play on the term.

- The phrase rendered "inert by nature" translates rang bzhin gyis bems po yin pa, literally "being inert or insentient by nature." The point is that emptiness itself has no cognitive activity and therefore cannot be an object of knowing or perceiving — a standard Madhyamaka clarification that emptiness is not itself a positive cognizable entity.

The closing sentence of the passage is syntactically open and ends mid-construction in the source text, indicating the speech continues in the passage that follows. This has been preserved faithfully.

- The epithet "Māyā" here refers to Queen Māyā, the historical mother of the Buddha Śākyamuni — the text uses the term "lhamo sgyu 'phrul," literally "goddess Illusion," as her proper name. The passage deliberately plays on the double meaning of māyā as both the queen's name and the word for "illusion," reinforcing the philosophical point about the illusory nature of the Tathāgata's birth.

The phrase "unwitnessed crown protrusion" renders the uṣṇīṣa (the cranial protrusion of a great being) that cannot be seen from above — this is one of the traditional marks of a buddha, specifically the one no being is able to behold from any elevated vantage point.

The "rains retreat among the Thirty-Three gods" alludes to the traditional account of Śākyaṃuni's ascent to Trāyastriṃśa heaven to teach Abhidharma to his deceased mother — a well-known episode in the received biographical tradition.

- The term rendered "issuing forth" throughout is a translation of the Tibetan for "definitive emergence" or "transcendence" in this context, carrying the sense of liberation or issuing out of conditioned existence. The dialogue plays on this term's semantic range between "arising" and "going forth beyond," and the Blessed One's answers exploit that ambiguity to make the Madhyamaka point that true liberation is not an object of cognition or intention.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, consistent with the passage being a continuous excerpt; the translation preserves this open ending.

- The divine youth Candraprabha, whose name means "Moonlight" or "Moon-radiance," is named as Zla ba in the Tibetan; the Sanskrit equivalent Candraprabha is used here for consistency with the doctrinal register of the text.

The phrase rendered "has never been seen before" translates *ngon ma mthong ba*, which carries the sense of something encountered as utterly fresh and unprecedented — beyond the scope of ordinary cognizing minds. This is a doctrinal point: because the Tathāgata is not reducible to any conditioned phenomenon, every perception of him by an obstructed mind is, in a real sense, a non-seeing, and the "unseen" quality is thus a positive characterization of his transcendence, not a mere absence.

- The phrase rendered "a term borrowed from the dharmadhātu" translates धर्मधातुसंज्ञा, literally "a word superimposed upon / borrowed against the dharmadhātu." The term संज्ञा (literally "borrowed" or "superimposed") indicates that the label is a conventional designation applied to the dharmadhātu for the sake of communication, not an intrinsic description of it. This same logic applies symmetrically to "attained" and "non-arising" later in the passage.

The final line breaks mid-sentence in the source, signaling that the passage continues; the translation breaks accordingly.

- [illegible]

The god's son "Candra" (Zla ba, literally "Moon") continues from the preceding narrative context established before this passage.

- The passage on clarity is dialectically dense. The dialogue moves through a series of questions about where clarity resides, concluding that true clarity belongs to that which is entirely beyond the dualism of aversion and affection, and even beyond what ordinary beings call clarity. The point is that genuine clarity, like the dharmadhātu itself, transcends the framework of joining and separation entirely. The "five qualities" to which one should quickly apply oneself are mentioned but not enumerated in this passage; they presumably appear in the surrounding context of the full text.

The final exchange establishes the paradox central to Mahāyāna soteriology: the prophecy was granted not because the bodhisattva moved from one set of phenomena to another, but because he realized there is nothing to abandon and nothing to attain — a characteristically Madhyamaka formulation.

- The phrase rendered "tolerance of the unborn" translates the standard Mahāyāna technical term for anutpattikadharmakṣānti, the bodhisattva's patient acceptance or tolerance of the fact that phenomena do not ultimately arise. This is a high attainment on the bodhisattva path, typically associated with the seventh or eighth ground.

The "perfect limit" renders yang dag pa'i mtha', a translation of the Sanskrit bhūtakoti, meaning the ultimate boundary or limit of reality, often used as a synonym for emptiness and suchness.

"King Bimbisāra's palace" renders rgyal po gzugs can snying po'i khang pa, literally "the palace of King Essence of Form," which is the standard Tibetan rendering of King Bimbisāra's name.

- The text mentions "the home of the young Licchavi Vimalacandra" — the Tibetan reads "Dri ma med pa'i zla ba'i khyim," literally "the home of Vimalacandra (Stainless Moon)." This appears to be a Licchavi noble otherwise not prominent in the standard sūtra corpus; the rendering follows the Tibetan exactly.

The passage describing the Tathāgata appearing simultaneously in multiple locations — Rājagṛha, the Jeta Grove, the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, the Śākya city, Vaiśālī, and Vārāṇasī — is the central miraculous theme being developed. The figure "comparable to Mahāmaudgalyāyana" seen always to the Blessed One's left is the same monk

Mahāmaudgalyāyana had noticed earlier; the text's doctrinal point is the omnipresent simultaneous manifestation of the Tathāgata across locations and realms.

- The passage lists the six desire-realm heavens in their standard cosmological order: the realm of the Four Great Kings, the Heaven of the Thirty-Three (Trāyastriṃśa), Yāma, Tuṣita, Nirmāṇarati, and Paranirmitavaśavartin. These are rendered by their standard Sanskrit equivalents without further gloss, as they follow a well-known canonical enumeration.

The five-limbed prostration refers to the traditional form in which both knees, both palms, and the forehead touch the ground simultaneously.

The sentence ends mid-construction in the source, cut off at the question the gods pose to the Blessed One; the translation reflects this open ending faithfully.

- The verse comparing the Victor's "conduct of mind" uses the phrase that is literally "the Victor's conduct of the mind is not encompassed by thought," meaning inconceivable — this is a standard doctrinal formula and has been rendered accordingly.

The phrase rendered "the last trace of the three defilements" translates a term indicating the third and most subtle level of defilement, implying that all three levels have been abandoned entirely.

The verse about the goddess of illusion is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; "Māyā" here almost certainly refers to the goddess who invited the Buddha to Mount Meru in the narrative frame, and the translation reflects this. This could alternatively refer to the magical display performed by Maudgalyāyana, but context favors the former reading.

- The "five limbs" prostration refers to the traditional full prostration in which forehead, two palms, and two knees touch the ground, a well-attested Indic devotional posture.

The heaven of Nirmāṇarati and Paranirmitavaśavartin are the fifth and sixth of the six desire-realm heavens. The Tibetan renders them as "Rab 'phrul dag" and "Gzhan 'phrul dbang byed dag" respectively, which are standard Tibetan translations of these Sanskrit names.

"Uttarakuru" for "Byang gi sgra mi snyan gyi gling" reflects a common Tibetan periphrasis: the northern continent is called "Uttarakuru" in Sanskrit, but the Tibetan literally means "the northern continent of unpleasant sound." Similarly Pūrvavideha and Godānīya are standard identifications for the eastern and western continents.

- The verse on the udumbara flower employs a classical simile for the rarity of a buddha's appearance; the udumbara (*Ficus racemosa*) was held to flower only once in countless eons, making it a standard image for the inconceivable rarity of a buddha's arising.

The opening lament in verse, where the speaker grieves at being "fallen low" from the buddha vehicles into a lesser state, reflects the standard Mahāyāna critique of the arhat's attainment as an inferior accomplishment compared to full buddhahood. The speaker is voicing regret at having pursued the śrāvaka path rather than the bodhisattva path, and the jewel-and-shell simile is a pointed condemnation of that choice.

The phrase rendered "sovereign lord of Dharma" translates a compound meaning one who holds dominion over the Dharma, a high epithet for a buddha.

- The phrase rendered "category of Dharma" translates a technical compound meaning a doctrinal enumeration or synonym-set (paryāya) for a teaching; the title "Miraculous Display of the Tathāgata's Supernatural Power" is the name of the text or discourse being introduced.

The four fruits of the contemplative life are the four śrāvaka attainments: stream-enterer, once-returner, non-returner, and arhat. The passage states that only the first three are mentioned by name in the Tibetan here, with the fourth (arhat) implicit in those who actualize

the supernatural knowledges and pass beyond sorrow. This is a genuine textual peculiarity worth noting.

"Seven palm-trees" is a canonical Indian measure of height used in descriptions of superhuman ascent before parinirvāṇa.

- The passage names three buddha-fields with paired Tathāgatas whose names appear to be deliberately swapped or interlocking in the Tibetan: the field "Source of Jewels" has the buddha "Heap of Jewels," and the field "Endowed with Manifold Jewels" has the buddha "Source of Jewels." This chiastic arrangement appears intentional in the text rather than a scribal error, and the translation preserves it as given.

The "two conditions" by which pratyekabuddha-vehicle beings attain complete awakening upon rebirth in empty buddha-fields is left unexplained in this passage; it is likely a reference to the accumulations of merit and wisdom, though the text does not specify here.

- The phrase rendered "the diamond-word-wheel of the three cycles of the dhāraṇī, the category of Dharma known as the Bodhisattva's Scriptural Treasury — being wholly complete and unbroken" is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan. The passage describes a specific doctrinal text or Dharma category by name; the rendering follows the most natural reading of the genitive chain, though the precise referent of "three cycles" is not further specified in the passage itself.

The term "gandharvas" translates the Tibetan *dri za* literally "smell-eaters," a class of semi-divine beings; the Sanskrit equivalent is given on first use in the glossary above as context but is here clarified in the translation as *gandharvas*, consistent with the standard list *gods-nāgas-yakṣas-gandharvas*.

- The epithet "Good Intelligence" for the *māra Blo gros bzang po* (Sanskrit *Sumati* or *Subuddhi*) is a straightforward rendering; no significant uncertainty there. The phrase rendered "great captain" (*ded dpon chen po*) literally means "great caravan leader" or "great merchant captain," a bodhisattva epithet also used for the Buddha; the sense of a guide leading beings across the ocean of *saṃsāra* is implied but not spelled out in the text, so the literal honorific is preserved in translation.

- The term rendered "koṭi times one hundred thousand" translates the Tibetan "*khrag khrig phrag*" which represents the standard large-number unit *niyuta* or more precisely the compound *niyuta-koṭi*; the figure thirty of these units is rendered literally throughout. The repetitive structure listing the four fruits of the *śrāvaka* path followed by pratyekabuddha awakening is a standard scholastic enumeration and has been preserved in sequence. The grass name "*kācaliṇḍika*" is a transliteration of an Indian plant name used as a simile for soft, pleasant ground cover; it appears untranslated here as it functions as a proper botanical reference. The city name "*Suśreṣṭhā*" is a reconstruction from the Tibetan "*bzang mchog*" meaning "excellent, supreme"; the world-realm name "Variegated" renders "*kun nas sna tshogs can*." The directional phrase "between east and south" renders the Tibetan "*shar dang lho'i phyogs mtshams*," meaning the intermediate direction southeast.

- The phrase rendered "eighty-four thousand royal consorts and women" reflects the Tibetan's apparent doubling of the number "eighty-four thousand" in the source, which may be a scribal dittography; however, it has been rendered faithfully as found without emendation.

The epithet "Discerning Intelligence" (*rnam par phyed ba'i blo gros*) could also be rendered "Discerning Wisdom" or "Analytical Intellect"; "Discerning Intelligence" is chosen as the most natural English for a world-realm name.

- The five superknowledges (Tibetan: *mngon par shes pa lnga*) are: the divine eye, the divine ear, knowledge of others' minds, recollection of past lives, and supernormal powers. The sixth, knowledge of the exhaustion of defilements, belongs to arhats alone and is not included here

as the bodhisattvas have not yet completed that path.

The term *kacāliṇḍika* refers to a particularly fine and soft variety of cloth; the precise Sanskrit is uncertain but the sense "soft as fine cotton or silk" is secure.

The phrase "sandalwood serpents" (Tibetan: *tsandan sbrul*) likely refers to a specific variety of sandalwood, possibly a poetic or mythological designation for a prized type; the exact referent is uncertain.

- The "second patient acceptance" renders *bzod pa gnyis pa*, which in this context likely refers to the second of the four acceptances described in certain Mahāyāna abhidharma enumerations, or alternatively to the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena as a second attainment distinct from the first. The passage immediately below confirms the bodhisattva confers the acceptance of non-arising on others, making this reading coherent. The precise numbering system varies across texts and is worth noting for specialist readers.
- The term rendered "blocked his almsround routes with thorns and branches" translates a phrase indicating that the inhabitants placed thorns and cut branches across the roads to obstruct the Tathāgata's almsround. The reading is straightforward but the specific act described is unusual enough to note.

The phrase rendered "the obstruction of karma" reflects the Tibetan for karmic obscuration as the cause of rebirth in that difficult realm; the bodhisattva has voluntarily taken birth there despite such conditions in order to ripen beings.

- The phrase rendered "one hundred billion world-realms of the four great continents" translates *bye ba phrag brgya*, literally "ten million times one hundred," i.e., one hundred million or, in the traditional Indic cosmological reckoning that underlies this text, one billion — the standard figure for a great trichiliocosm. The rendering "one hundred billion" follows the conventional Tibetan-Buddhist English rendering of this cosmological formula.
- The phrase rendered "sixty qualities" refers to the traditional sixty qualities of the Buddha's voice, a well-attested list in Mahāyāna literature. The phrase "four kinds of miraculous display" renders the Tibetan *cho 'phrul rnam pa bzhi*, a standard enumeration of the Tathāgata's modes of miraculous manifestation; the specific list varies by source but the term is unambiguous.
- The passage contains a highly formulaic series of escalating analogies, a standard Mahāyāna rhetorical device for expressing the inconceivable scope of buddha-activity. The phrase rendered "let alone" translates the Tibetan rhetorical marker *"lta zhog gi,"* literally "set aside" or "never mind," used to dismiss each previous scale before introducing a grander one. The final sentence breaks off mid-enumeration, which is faithful to the source text as given, indicating the passage continues beyond the excerpt provided.
- The sequence of large numerical units — *bye ba*, *gtams-phrag*, *dkrigs-phrag*, *mi-'khrugs-phrag*, *grangs-med-pa-phrag*, *dpag-tu-med-pa-phrag* — represents a traditional Indian series of escalating numerical magnitudes. The exact Sanskrit equivalents of some middle terms (*gtams*, *dkrigs*, *mi-'khrugs*) are not entirely certain in this context, but the overall sense is clear: an ascending series of astronomically large numbers. This is noted here as the specific Sanskrit numerical terms underlying the second and third in the series are not universally agreed upon in the literature.
- The chapter title "The Chapter of the Thirty-Three" refers to the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, the realm of the gods where much of this display took place. The dual titling convention at the end is standard for sūtra colophons and chapter endings in this literature, giving both a structural and a thematic name.
- The passage ends mid-sentence in the colophon, cutting off after "the great editor" — the name of the Tibetan editor-translator is not present in the supplied text. The two divine sons named at the opening, *Zla ba* ("Moon") and *Zla mchog* ("Supreme Moon"), are left in their

Tibetan forms here as no standard Sanskrit equivalents are supplied in the passage; a fuller colophon would normally identify them. Mahāmaudgalyāyana is the great disciple of the Buddha usually known simply as Maudgalyāyana.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.